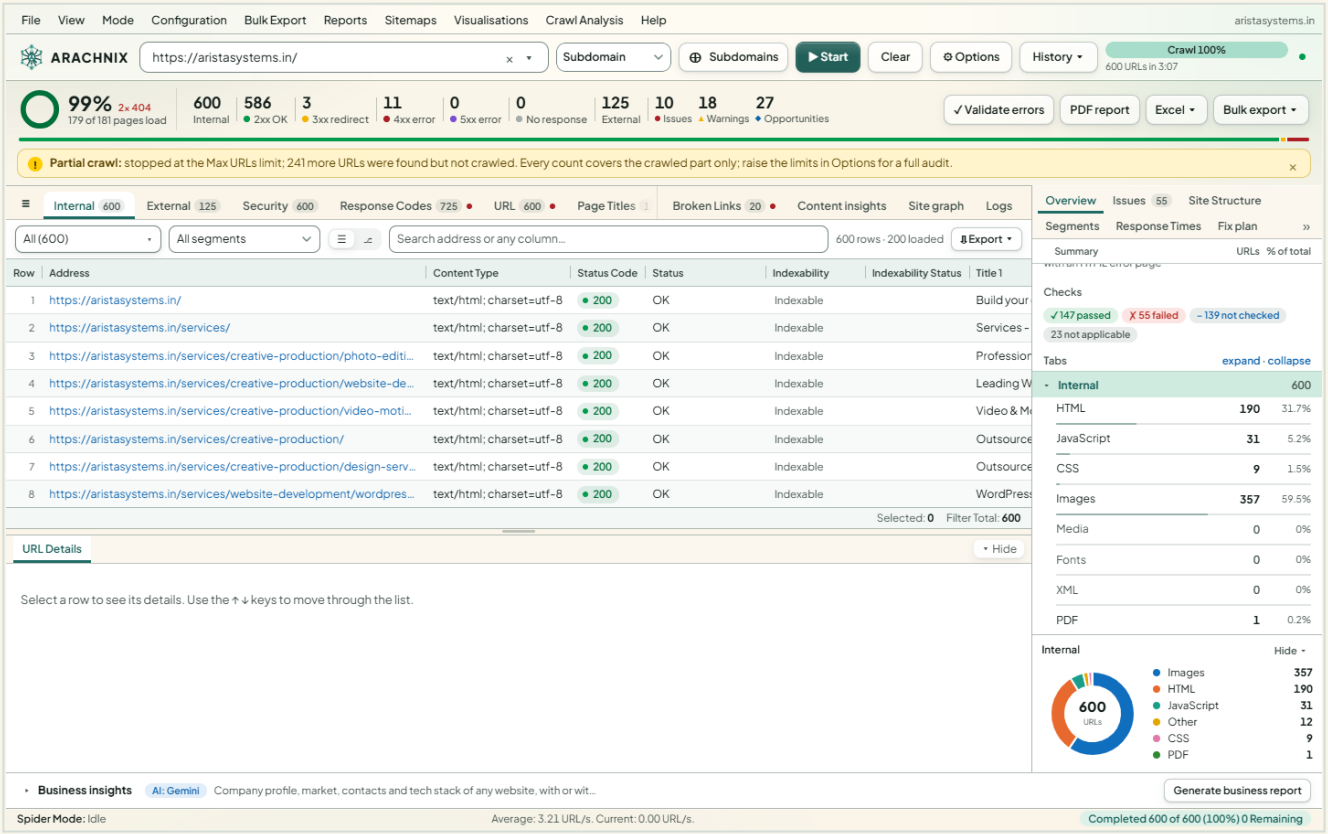
ARACHNIX

User Guide

version 2.0 · 30 October 2026

Run a crawl from start to finish: enter a site, read the results, find and fix issues, and share Excel and PDF reports. Every step shows the real screen.



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How to read this guide The numbers in the orange circles on each screenshot match the numbered actions above it. Words in **bold** are the exact labels on the screen.

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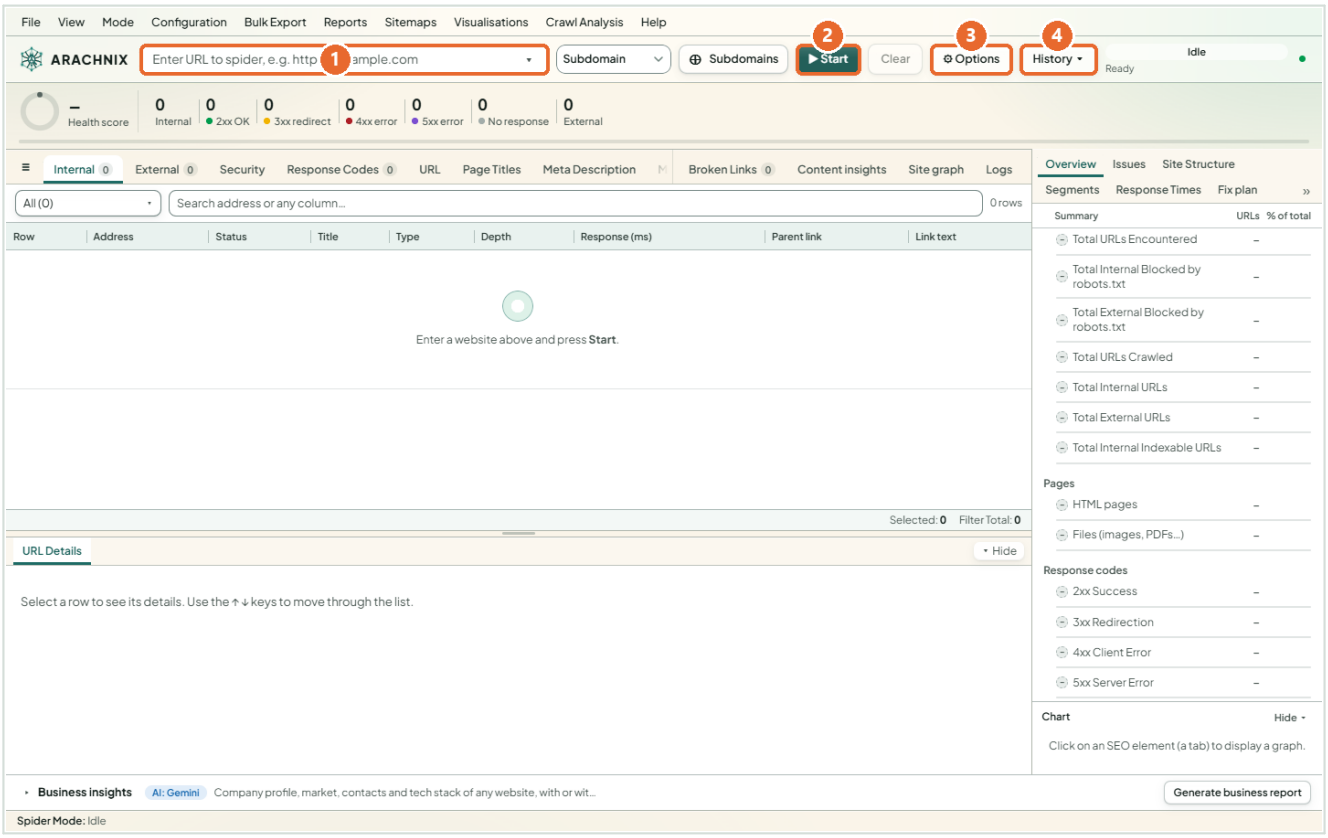
FAQ **33**

Getting started

ARACHNIX is the team's SEO crawler. It visits a website the way Google does and lists every page, link, image and problem it finds. It runs on a team server: all you need is a browser.

1. Open ARACHNIX

1. Open the ARACHNIX address your team uses in Chrome or Edge (if the server asks for an access key, enter the key your admin gave you). The empty start screen has the address box **Enter URL to spider**.
2. **Start** runs the crawl.
3. **Options** holds the crawl settings.
4. **History** lists earlier crawls. The menu bar on top (**File**, **View**, **Mode**, **Configuration** … **Help**) has everything else.



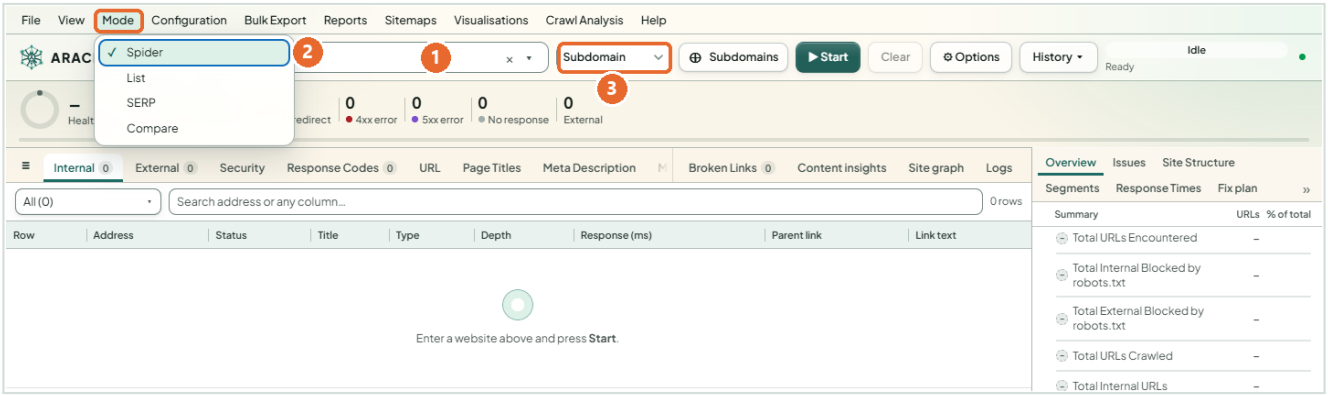
Tip The status at the top right says **Ready** when the server is free. The whole team uses the same server, so the crawl on screen is shared.

Run your first crawl

Three choices: the site, the mode and a few options. Then press Start.

2. Enter the site and pick the mode

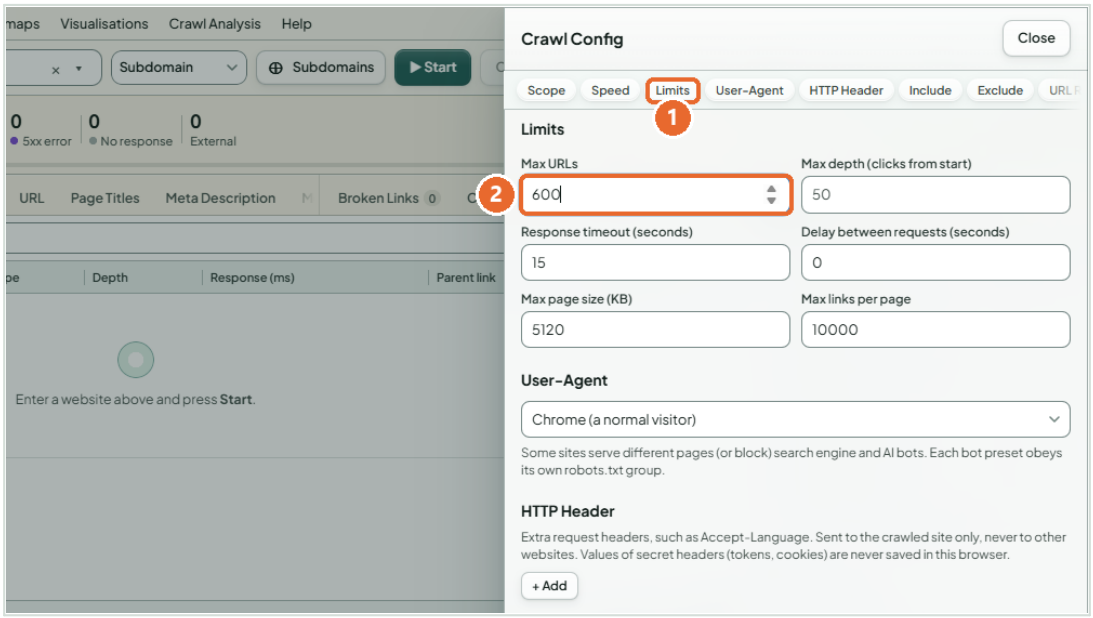
1. Type the site address in **Enter URL to spider**, for example *https://aristasystems.in*.
2. Keep **Mode > Spider** to follow every link from that page. **List** checks only URLs you paste or upload; **SERP** checks titles and descriptions without crawling; **Compare** compares two saved crawls.
3. Keep the scope on **Subdomain** (the start host only). **Subfolder** stays in one folder, **All Subdomains** also crawls shop., blog. and the like.



Tip Not sure which subdomains exist? **Subdomains** next to the scope finds them and says why each one is or is not crawled.

3. Set the few options most people need

1. Click **Options**. The **Crawl Config** panel opens; the buttons along its top jump to each section.
2. Under **Limits**, set **Max URLs**: a few hundred (here 600) is a quick first look, 0 means no limit.

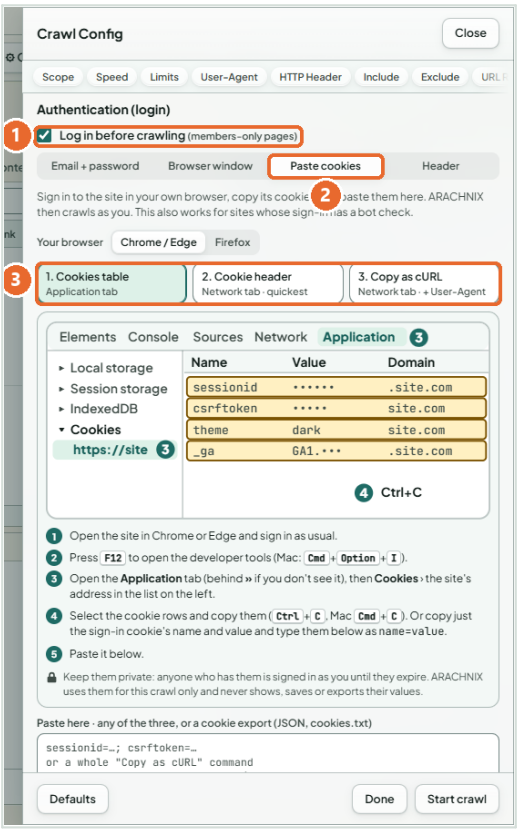


Tip The Options button then shows your limit (for example **max 600**), so you can check it before you start.

JavaScript sites and members-only sites

For sites built with React, Next.js or Vue, tick **Rendering > Render every page in Chrome** in Options. It is slower (about 2-3 seconds a page) but sees what visitors see. For pages behind a login:

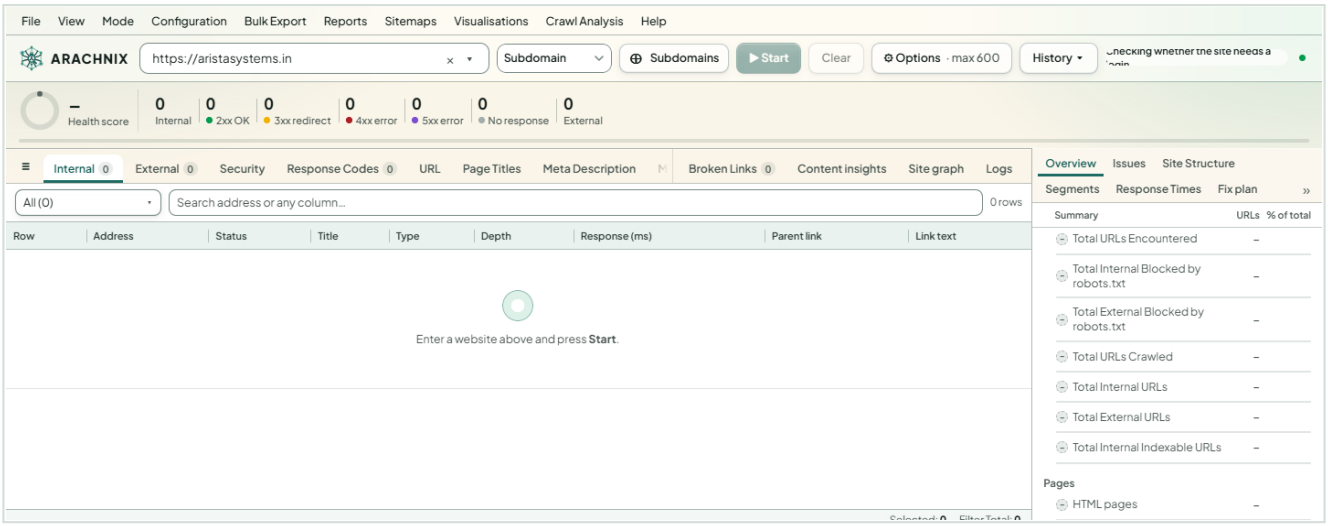
1. Open **Authentication (login)** and tick **Log in before crawling**.
2. Pick a method: **Email + password**, **Browser window** (you sign in yourself in a live window; two-factor works), **Paste cookies** or **Header**.
3. **Paste cookies** shows a step-by-step guide for Chrome / Edge and Firefox: sign in with your own browser, copy the cookies, paste them, then test. This also works when the sign-in has a bot check (CAPTCHA).

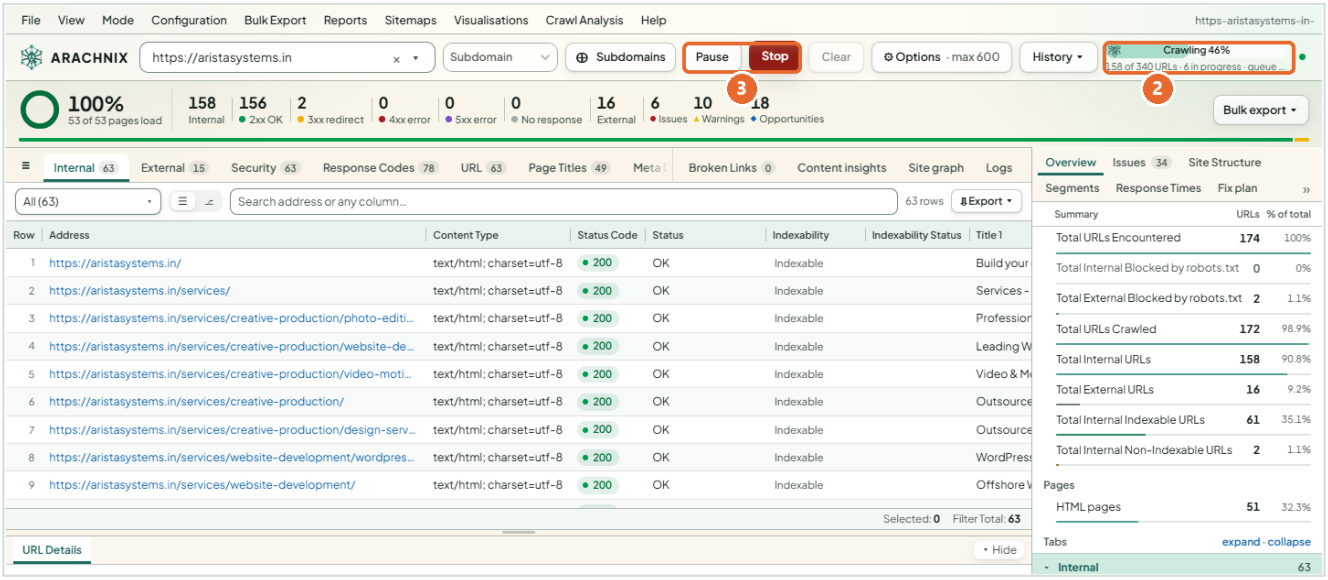


Tip Cookies and passwords are secrets: never paste them into a ticket, a chat or a screenshot. If a site shows a bot check, ARACHNIX never tries to solve it; it tells you what to do instead (see the FAQ).

4. Start the crawl and watch it run

1. Press **Start** (or **Start crawl** at the bottom of Options). The ARACHNIX spider animates while the crawl starts.
2. The status at the top right shows the progress (for example **Crawling 46%**) and the URLs done so far; rows fill the grid as pages are found.
3. **Pause** holds the crawl, **Stop** ends it early. Everything found so far is kept.





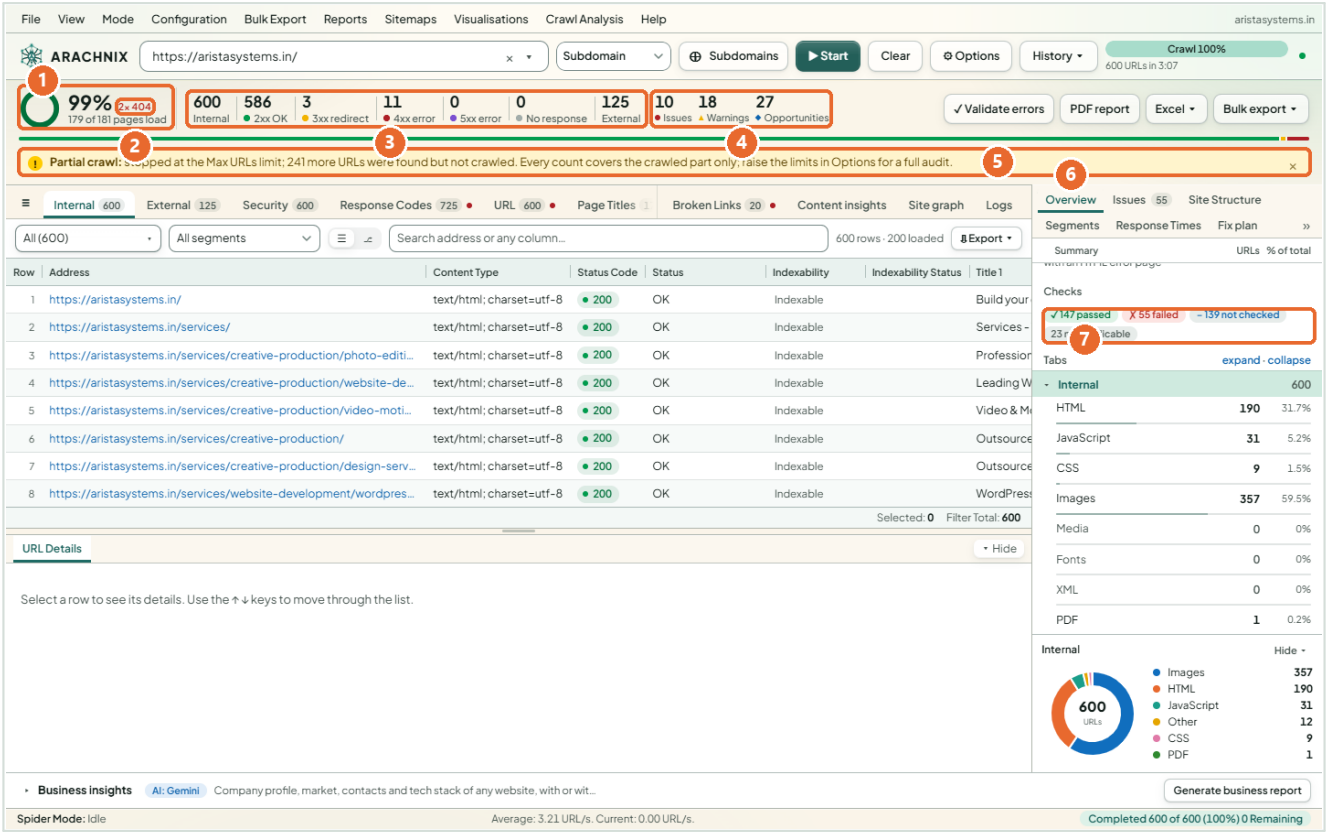
Tip You can close the browser tab: the crawl keeps running on the server. Open ARACHNIX again to see it.

Read the results

When the crawl ends, the screen shows the whole site at a glance.

5. The KPI strip and the Overview

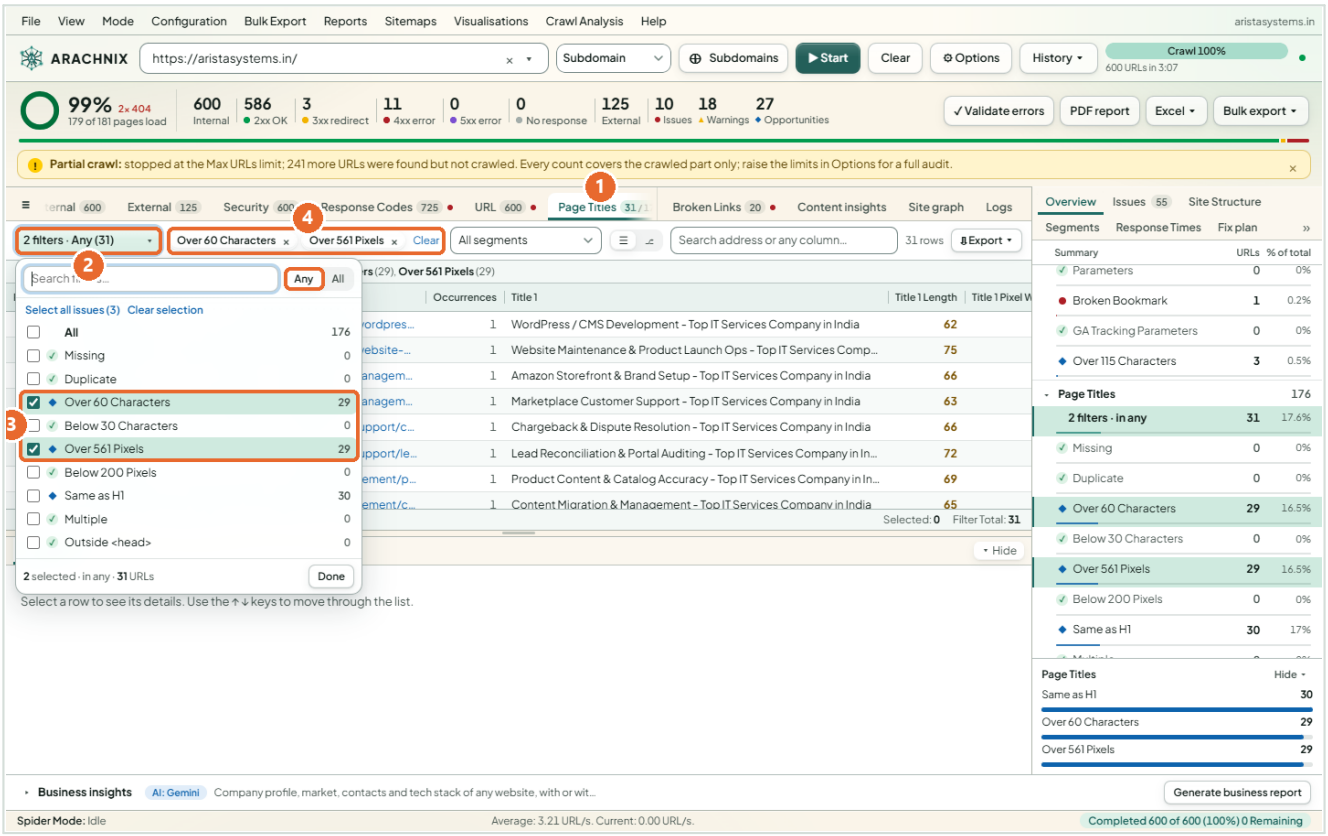
1. **Health score**: the share of pages that load without errors.
2. If some pages didn't load, a short red link next to the score says why (here **2× 404**). Click it to list exactly those pages in the grid (**Internal > Pages that didn't load**).
3. The counts **Internal**, **2xx OK**, **3xx redirect**, **4xx error**, **5xx error**, **No response** and **External**. Each URL is counted once, by its HTTP status, so the numbers always add up.
4. **Issues**, **Warnings** and **Opportunities**: three columns, each with its own coloured marker, counting the SEO checks that found problems.
5. A yellow note says when the crawl stopped early (here: at the Max URLs limit).
6. The **Overview** panel lists every tab and filter with its URL count. Click a line to show those URLs.
7. **Checks**: how many checks passed, failed or were not checked (for example, checks that need Chrome rendering).



Tip The top right shows how long the crawl took, for example **600 URLs in 3:07** (times read 42s, 4:22 or 1:04:22).

6. Tabs, filters and search

1. Pick a tab: **Internal**, **External**, **Security**, **Response Codes**, **URL**, **Page Titles** … The ≡ button at the left of the tabs lists all of them.
2. Open the filter box (it shows **All** at first) and pick a filter, such as **Over 60 Characters**.
3. Tick several filters at once. **Any** (the default) shows URLs in any of them, **All** only URLs in every one; counts are always distinct URLs.
4. The picked filters show as chips: **×** removes one, **Clear** removes all. Type in **Search address or any column…** to narrow the rows.



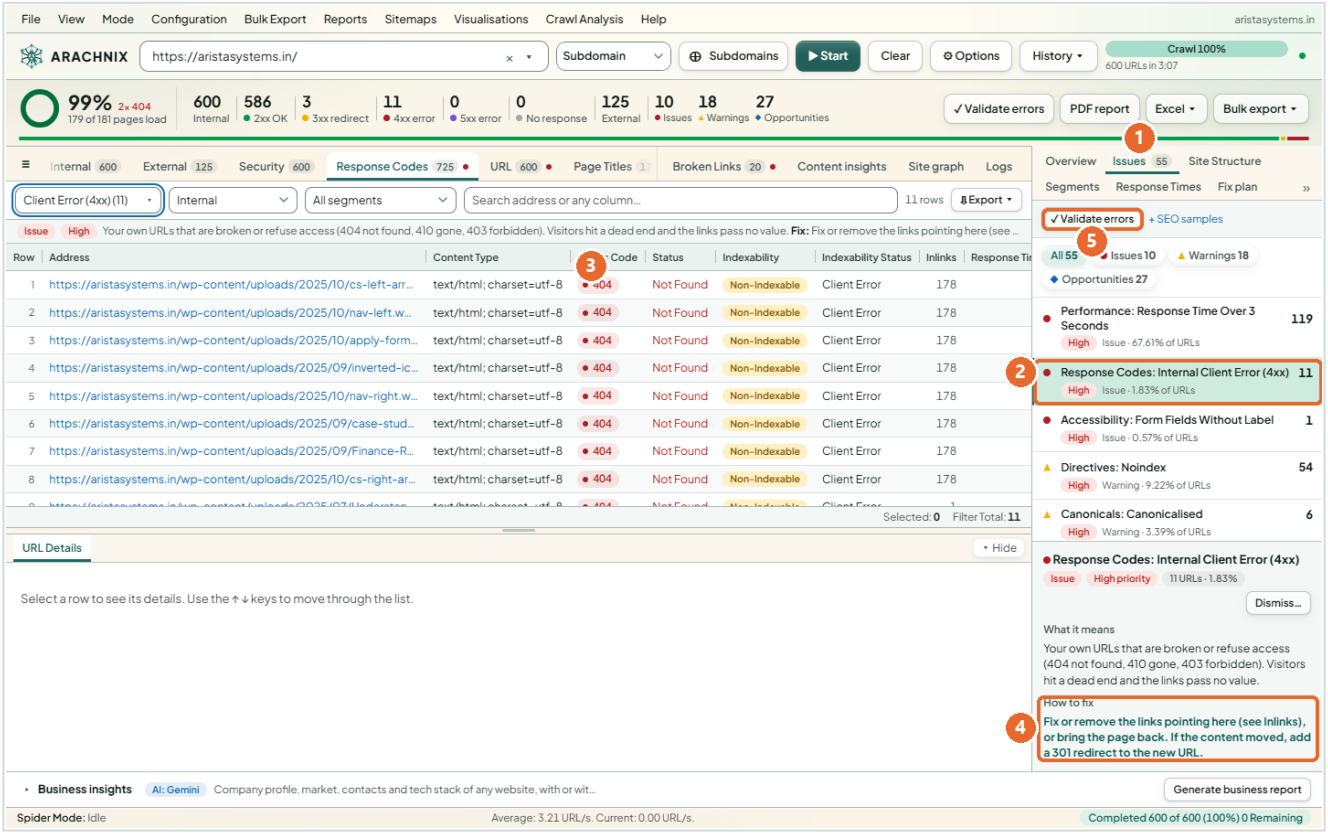
Tip Press **/** to jump to the search box. Click a column header to sort.

Find and fix issues

ARACHNIX ranks problems by priority and says how to fix each one.

7. The Issues panel

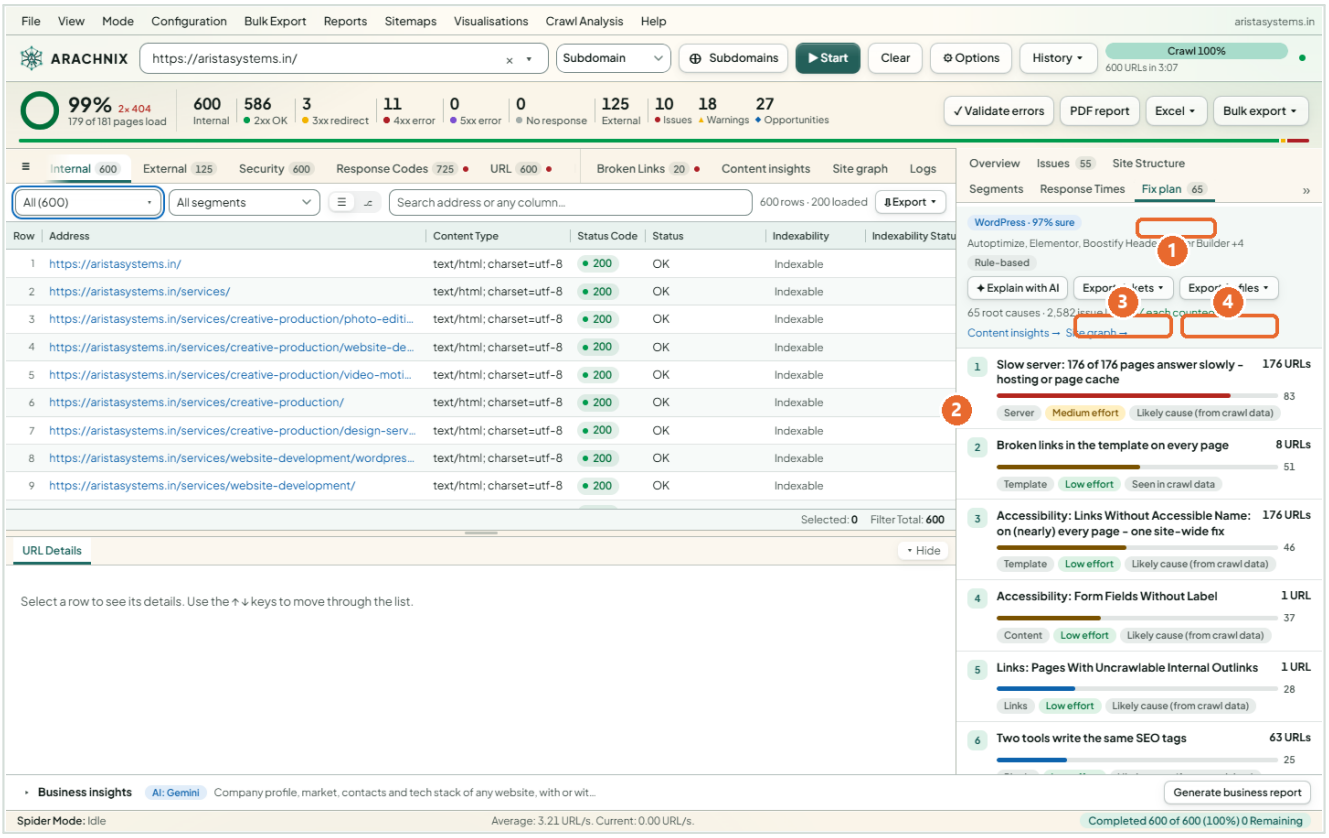
1. Click **Issues** in the right panel. Each line shows the issue, its priority (**High**, **Medium**, **Low**) and its URL count.
2. Click an issue.
3. The grid shows exactly those URLs.
4. **What it means** and **How to fix** appear under the list. **Dismiss…** marks an issue as fine for this site, with a note.
5. **Validate errors** re-checks every broken URL live (3 tries each), so you only report errors that are real.



Tip The chips **Issues**, **Warnings** and **Opportunities** filter the list.

The Fix plan: what to fix first

1. Click **Fix plan** in the right panel.
2. Issues are grouped by root cause, in fix-first order: one template fix often clears hundreds of URLs. Each card shows the URLs, the effort and the evidence.
3. **Export tickets**: one developer ticket per root cause (CSV, Jira import, Markdown, or a ZIP with screenshots).
4. **Export fix files**: ready-to-import fixes for Yoast, Rank Math, Shopify, .htaccess, Next.js or CSV.



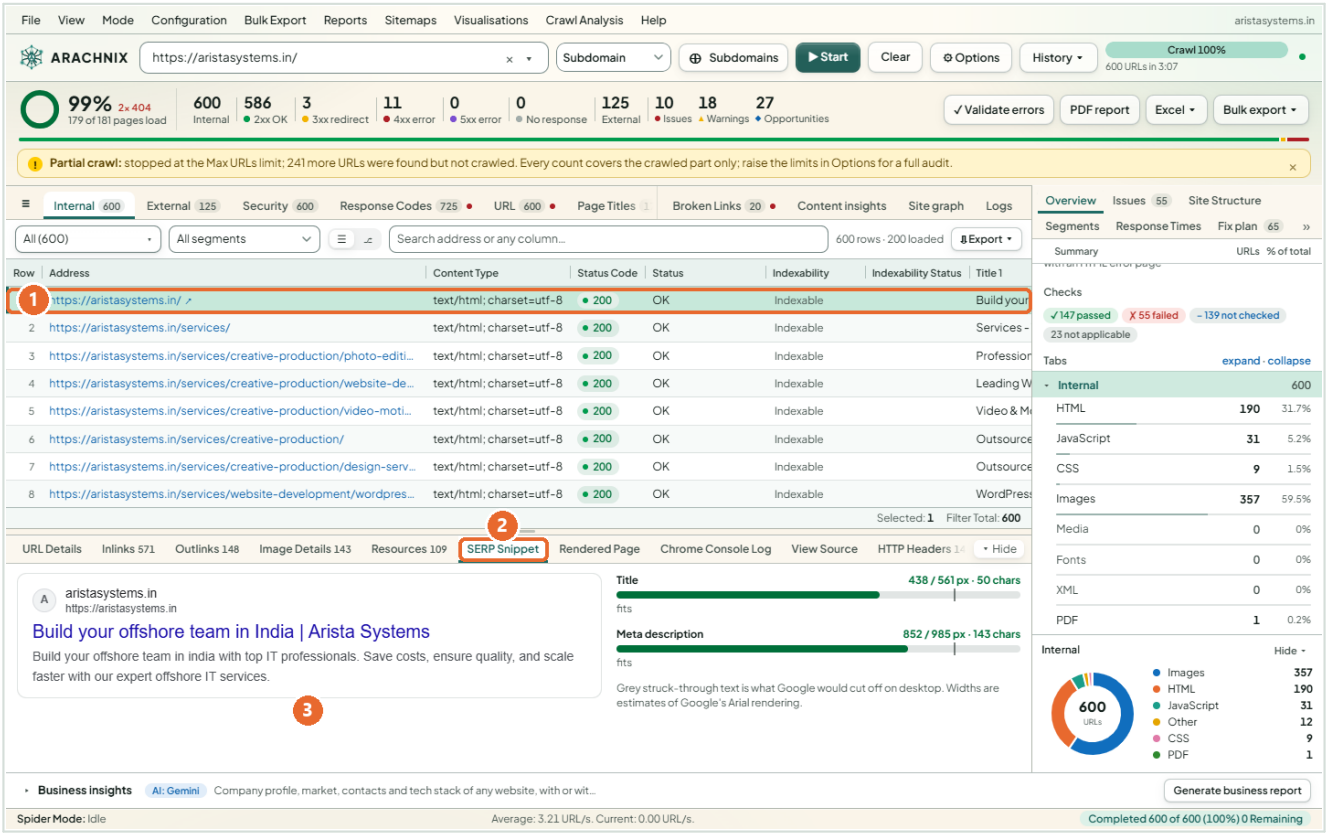
Tip The platform (here WordPress) is detected from the site, so the fix steps name the right plugin or setting.

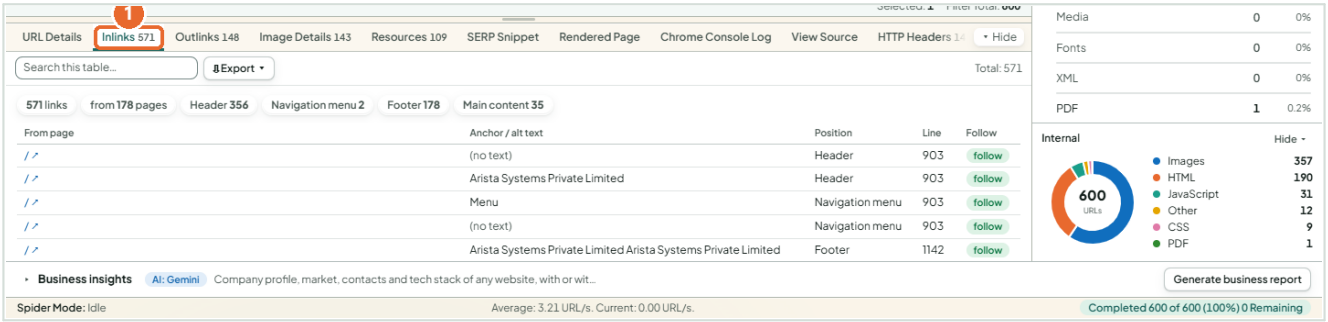
Look at one URL

Click any row: the bottom pane shows everything about that URL.

8. The URL details pane

1. Click a row in the grid (or move with the arrow keys).
2. Pick a tab in the bottom pane: **URL Details**, **Inlinks**, **Outlinks**, **Image Details**, **Resources**, **SERP Snippet**, **Rendered Page**, **View Source**, **HTTP Headers**, **Issues**, **Why & Fix** ...
3. **SERP Snippet** previews the Google result and measures the title and description in pixels.

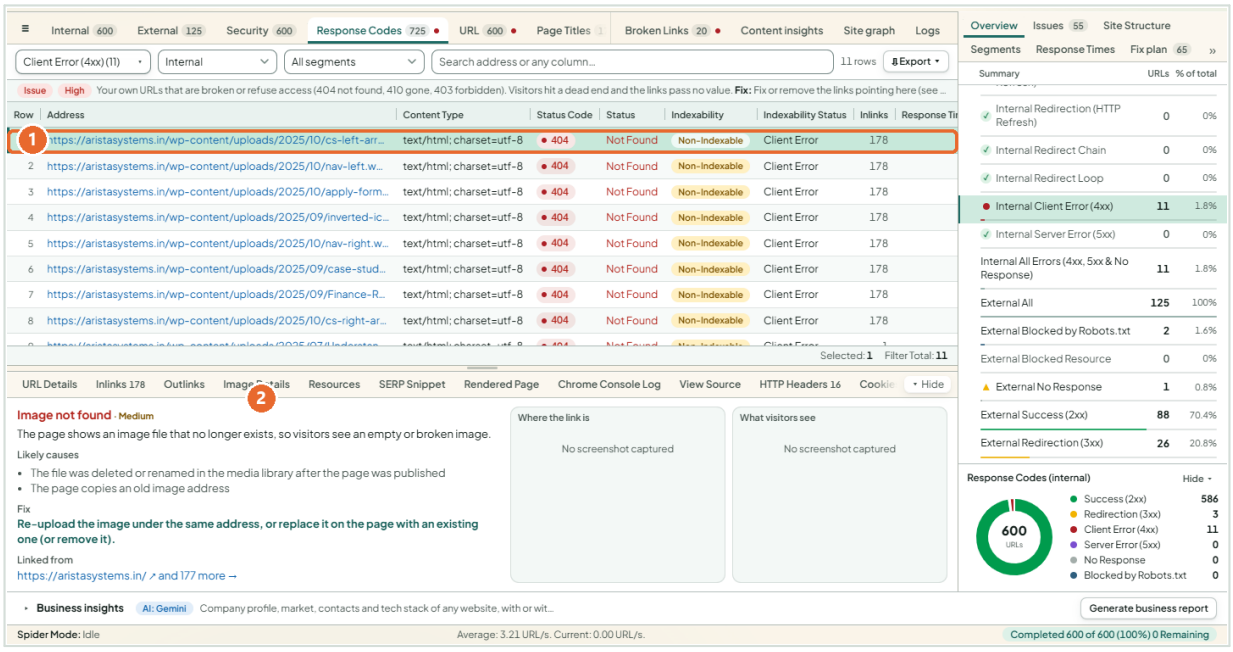


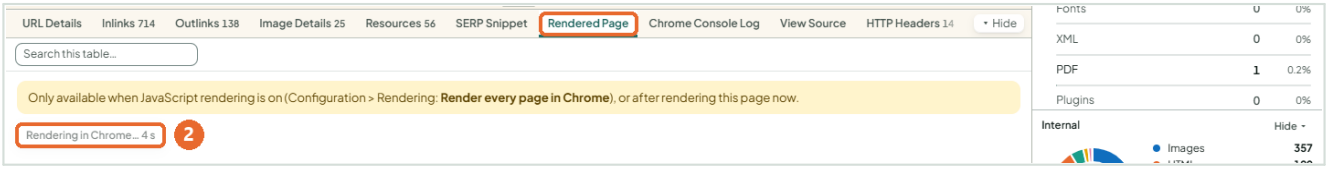


Inlinks: every page that links here, with the anchor text and where the link sits (header, menu, footer, content).

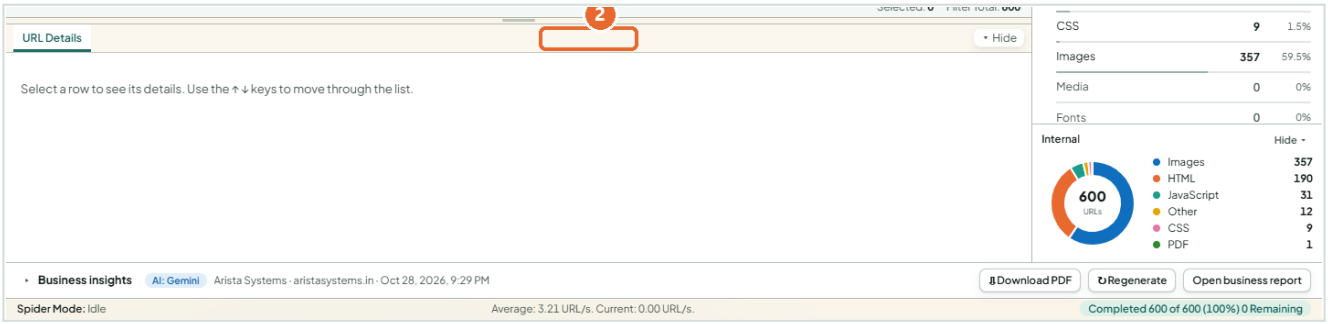
Why a URL is broken, and what the page looks like

1. Select a broken URL (for example from the 4xx issue). **Why & Fix** gives the likely cause, the fix and the pages that link to it.
2. **Rendered Page** shows the page as Chrome draws it, with its resources. If the crawl did not render pages, press **Render this page now**: the button counts the seconds while Chrome works (usually 5-15 s). If a rendered page has no screenshot yet, **Take a screenshot now** adds one.





While Chrome works the button shows **Rendering in Chrome... 4 s**; the screenshot appears when it is done.



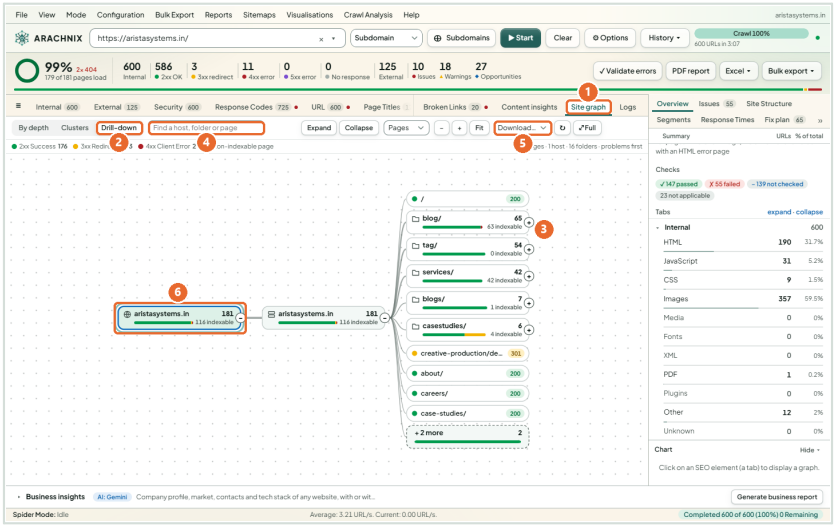
Tip **HTTP Headers** shows the server's answer, with green ticks for the security headers that are present.

Visualise the site

See how the site hangs together: folders, depth and links.

9. Site graph and drill-down

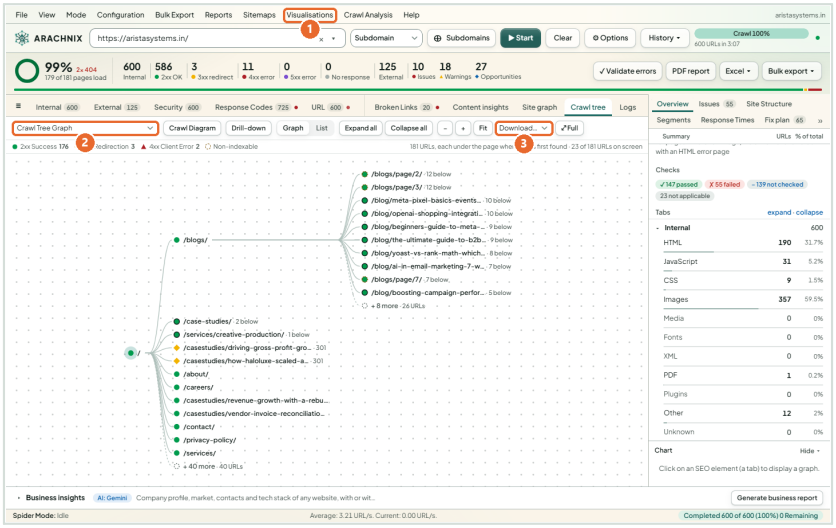
1. Click the **Site graph** tab.
2. Choose **Drill-down** to open the site level by level: domain, host, folders, pages.
3. Click **+** on a folder to open it. The bar shows how many pages are indexable; the colours show the status.
4. Type in **Find a host, folder or page** to jump to one.
5. **Download…** saves the graph as it is drawn now: **PNG image** or **SVG image** (sharp at any size).
6. The start of the site is marked with a pulsing teal ring, on a faint dot grid.



Tip **By depth** lays pages out by clicks from the start page; **Clusters** groups pages that link to each other.

Crawl tree and other diagrams

1. Open the **Visualisations** menu: **Crawl Tree Graph**, **Directory Tree Graph**, **Force-Directed Crawl Diagram**, **Drill-down Tree** and two word clouds.
2. Switch diagrams with the list at the top left. **Graph** / **List** changes the view; **Expand all** opens every branch.
3. Every diagram has the same **Download…** menu (PNG or SVG) and marks its start page in teal.



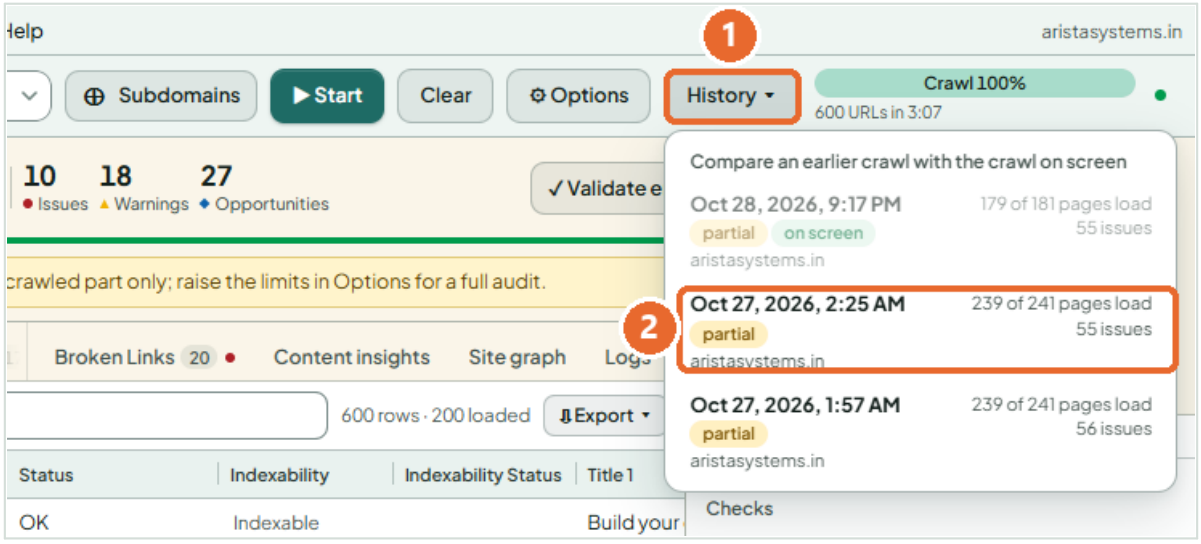
Tip Each page sits under the page where it was first found: long chains show pages that are hard to reach.

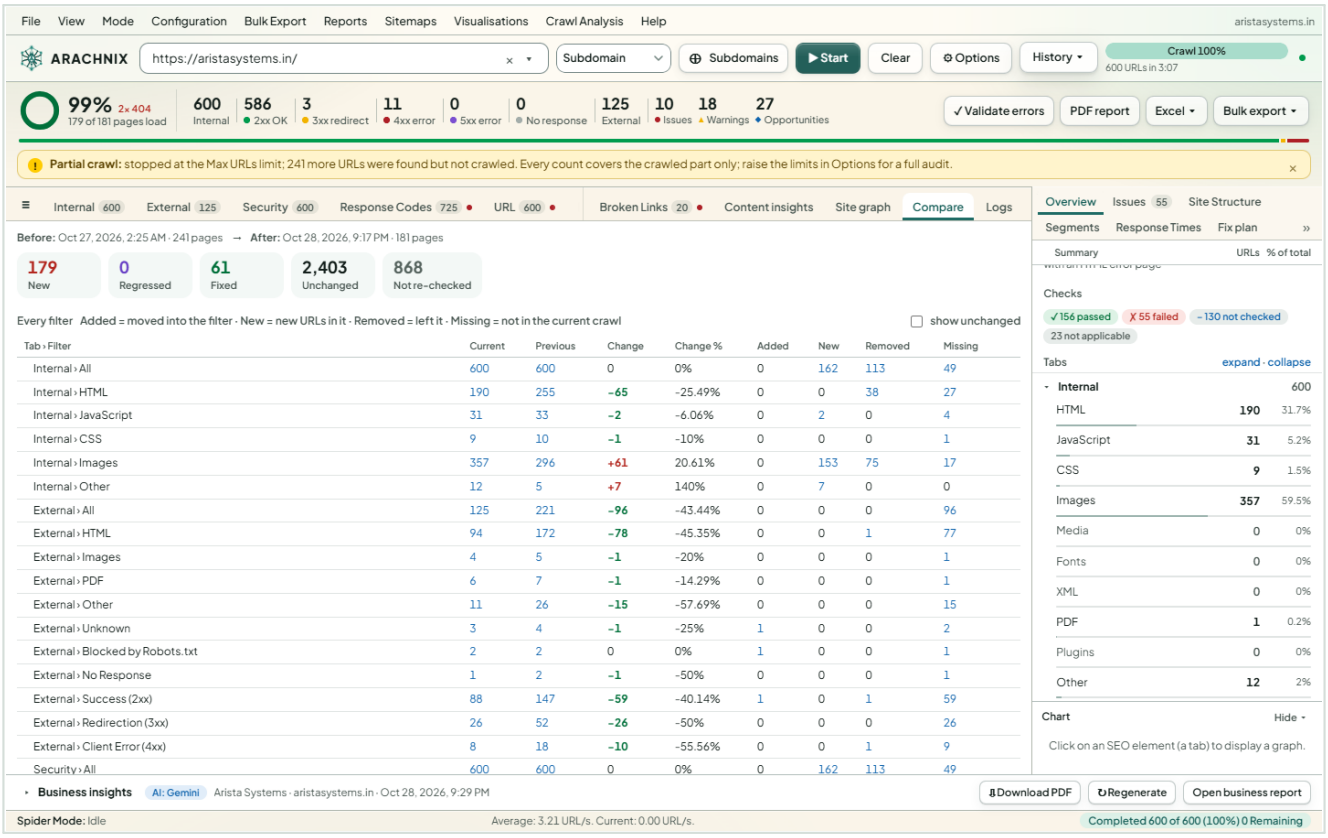
Compare crawls

Crawl the site again later and see what changed. Every finished crawl is saved, so there is nothing to set up.

10. Compare an earlier crawl with the crawl on screen

1. Click **History**.
2. Pick the earlier crawl of the same site. ARACHNIX opens the comparison.





Each filter shows **Added**, **New**, **Removed** and **Missing** URLs, and change detection lists pages whose title, description, H1, word count, depth, inlinks, indexability, status code, canonical, structured data or content changed.

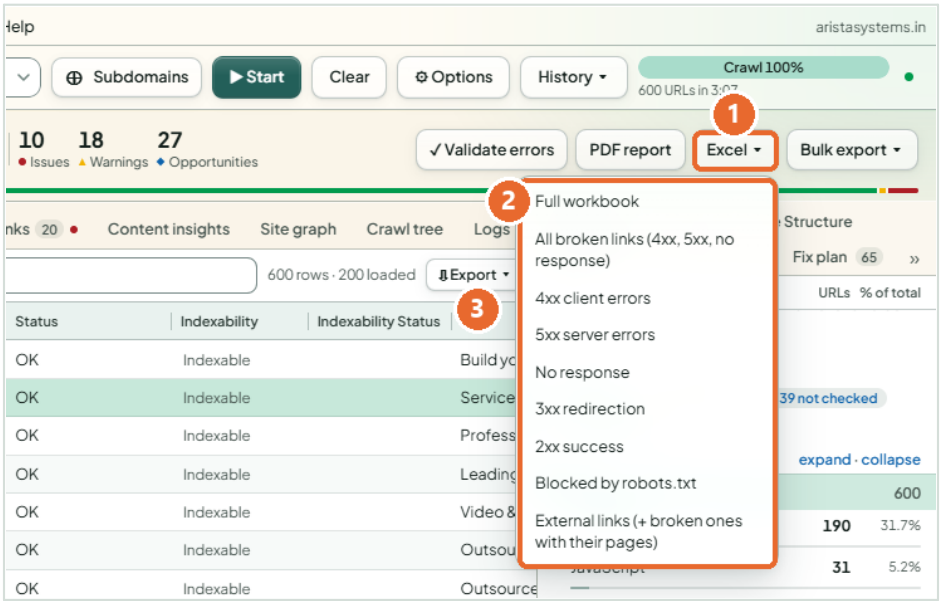
Tip To compare any two saved crawls, use **Mode > Compare** or **File > Crawls...**, tick two crawls and press **Compare**. If a deciding setting changed between them (for example the scope), ARACHNIX says the crawls are not comparable.

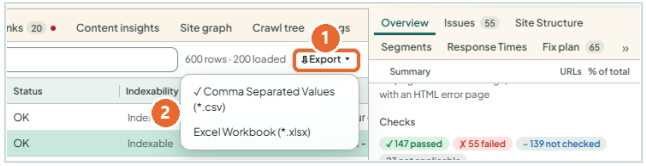
Export and share

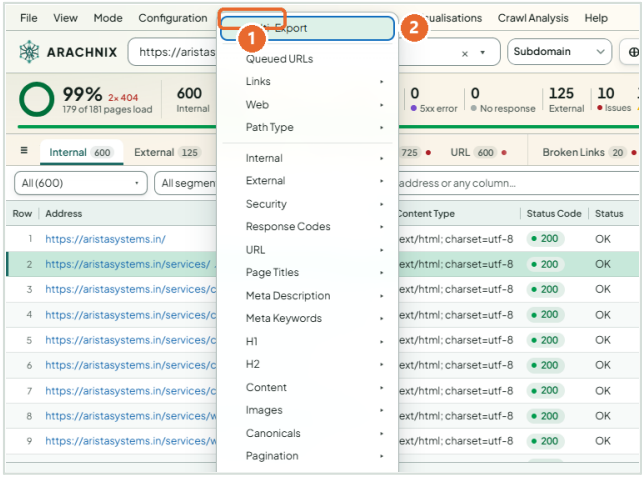
Excel for the team, PDF for clients and managers.

11. Excel, CSV and bulk exports

1. **Excel** (top right):
2. **Full workbook** has every tab in one file; the other entries are ready-made workbooks such as all broken links.
3. Each entry is one click and downloads straight away.



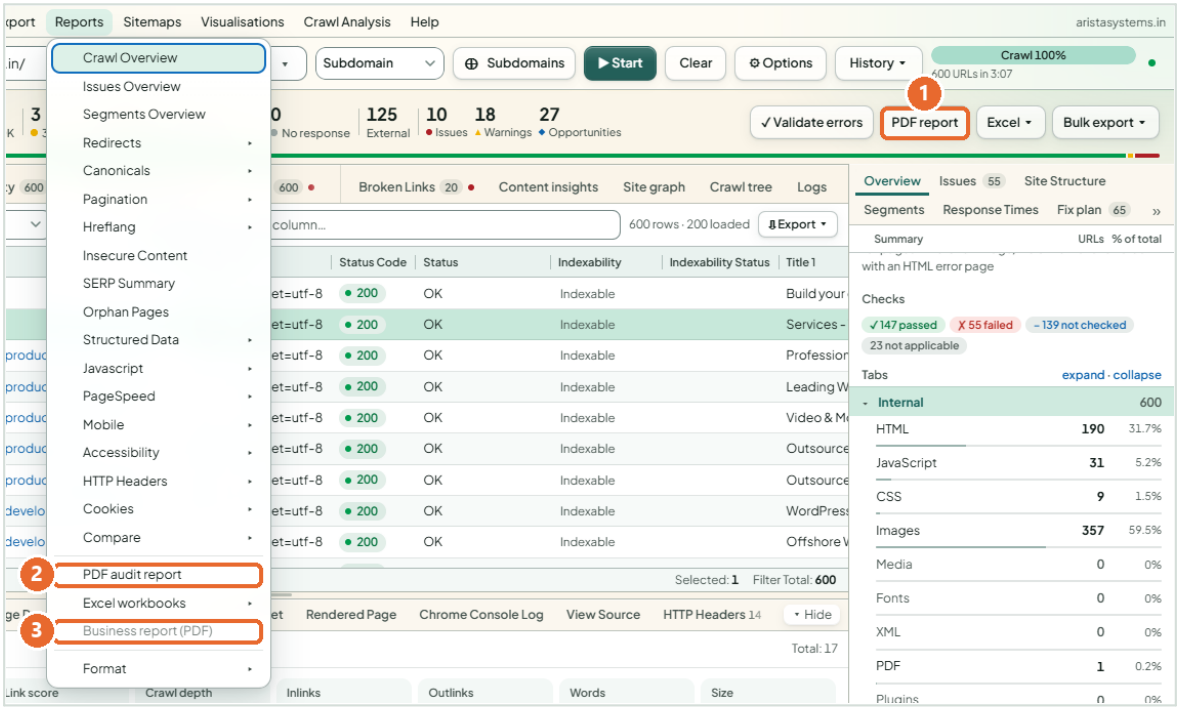


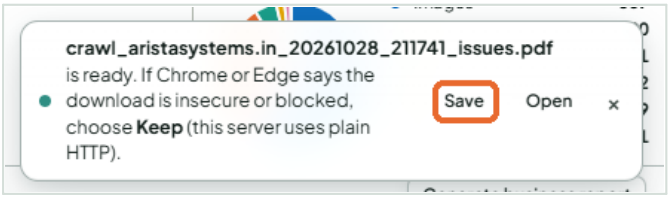


Left: **Export** above the grid downloads exactly what is on screen (tab, filters, search) as CSV or Excel. Right: the **Bulk Export** menu: all inlinks, all issues, redirect chains and more, by tab.

12. PDF reports

1. **PDF report** (top right, or **Reports > PDF audit report**) builds the Website Audit Report: a compact, client-ready PDF with the counts, what to fix first and the evidence. Larger sites take a minute while it prepares the pictures.
2. **Reports > Excel workbooks** has the same workbooks as the Excel button.
3. **Business report (PDF)** is ready once a business report exists (next page).

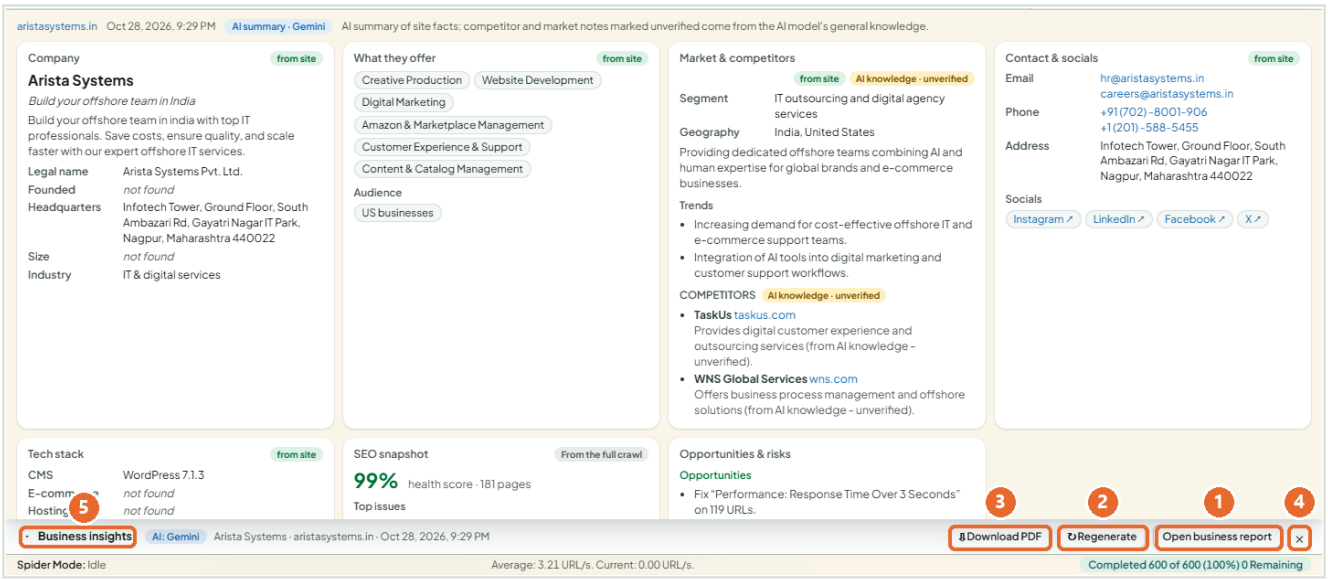


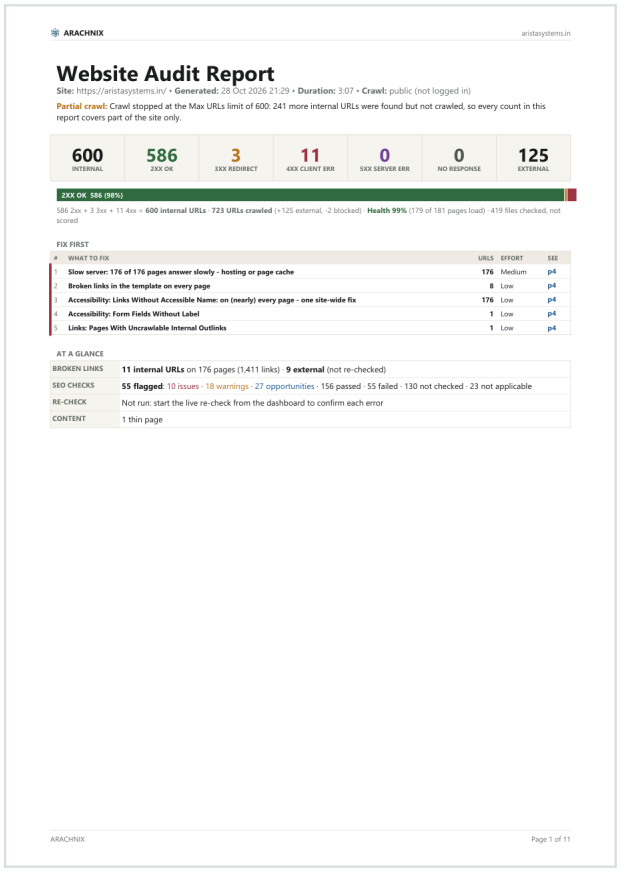


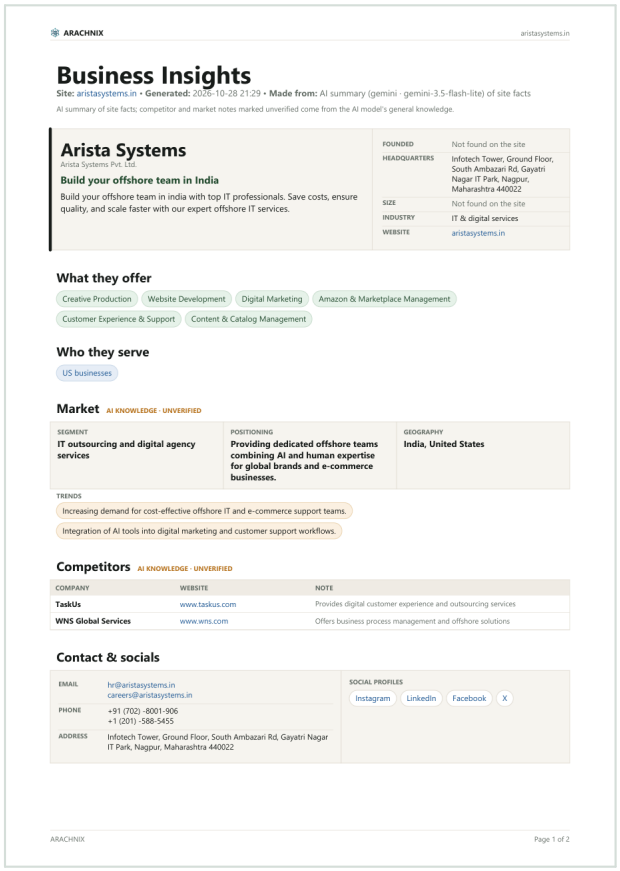
On the office network (plain HTTP) a file that took a while to prepare waits in a message at the bottom right: press **Save**. If Chrome or Edge then says the download is insecure or blocked, choose **Keep** in the browser's download list. PDFs can also be opened in a new tab with **Open**.

Business insights

1. At the bottom of the screen, press **Generate business report**. It researches the company behind the site: what it offers, its market, competitors, contacts and tech stack; the ARACHNIX logo and a bar show it working. If the site already has a report, the button says **Open business report** and opens it straight away.
2. **Regenerate** researches the company again and replaces the report.
3. **Download PDF** saves the Business Insights PDF.
4. × closes the panel.
5. **Business insights** also opens or closes it. Facts come from the site; market and competitor notes are marked *AI knowledge · unverified*.




Website Audit Report


Business Insights

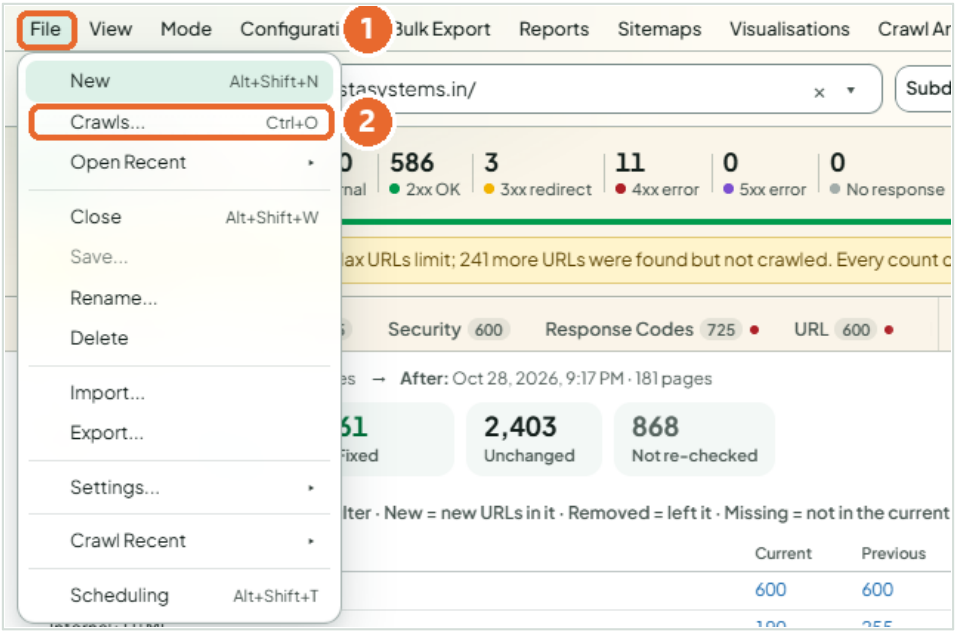
First pages: the Website Audit Report (left) and the Business Insights PDF (right).

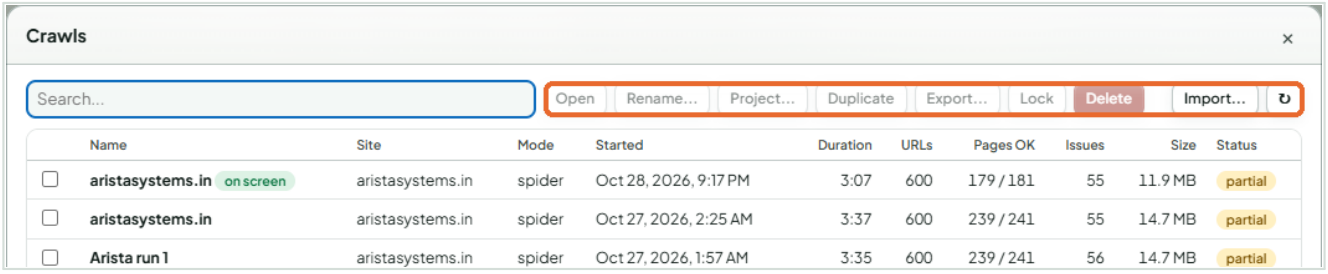
Saved crawls

Every finished crawl is saved on the server for the whole team.

13. Open, rename and manage saved crawls

1. Open **File**.
2. **Crawls…** (Ctrl+O) lists every saved crawl. From there you can open, rename, lock, export, import or delete one, or tick two and compare them. **Open Recent** reopens a recent crawl.





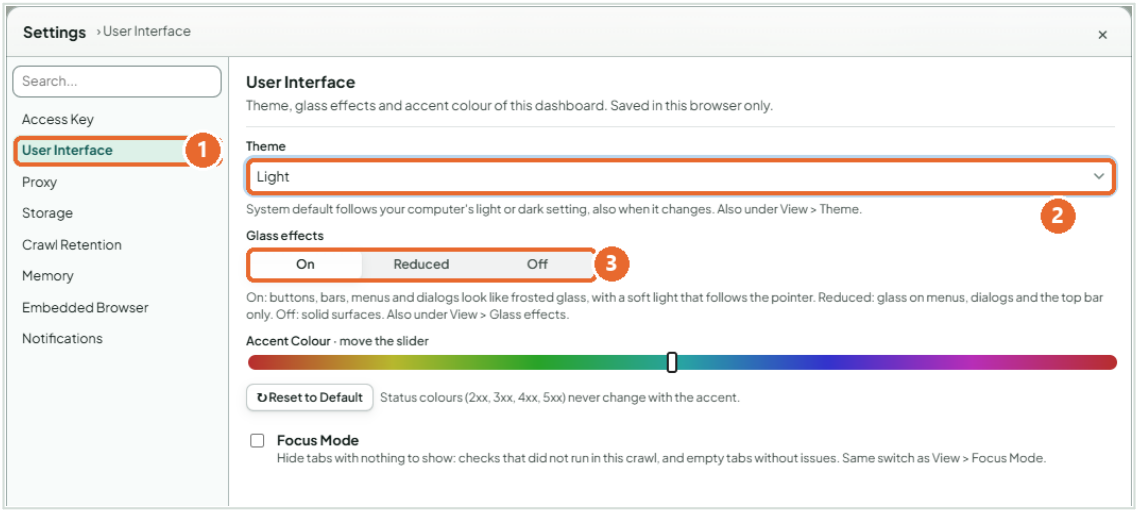
Tip **Clear** takes the crawl off the screen for everyone and empties the address box and the site name at the top right; the crawl stays saved under File > Crawls. To crawl another site you do not need to clear: type the new address and press Start.

Settings: theme and glass

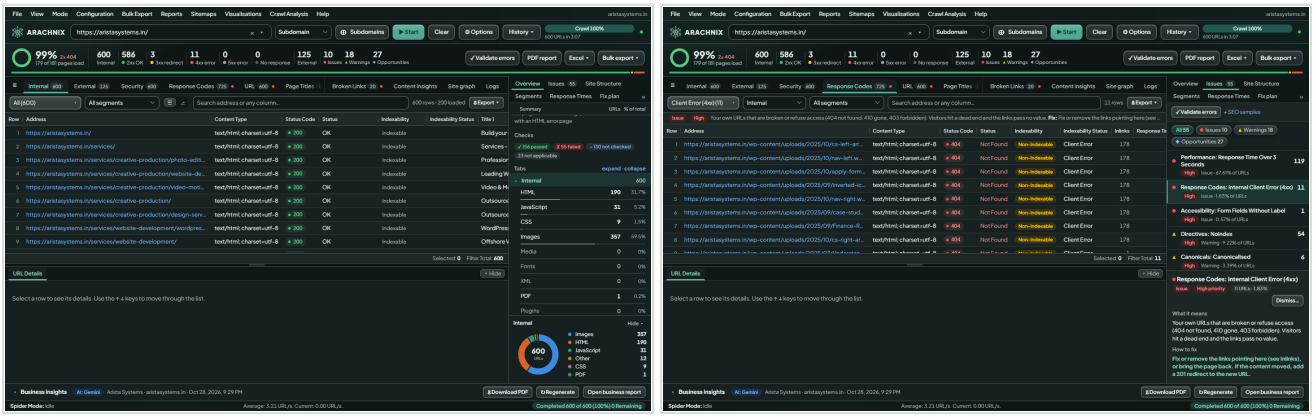
Choose how ARACHNIX looks. These choices are saved in your browser only.

14. Theme and glass effects

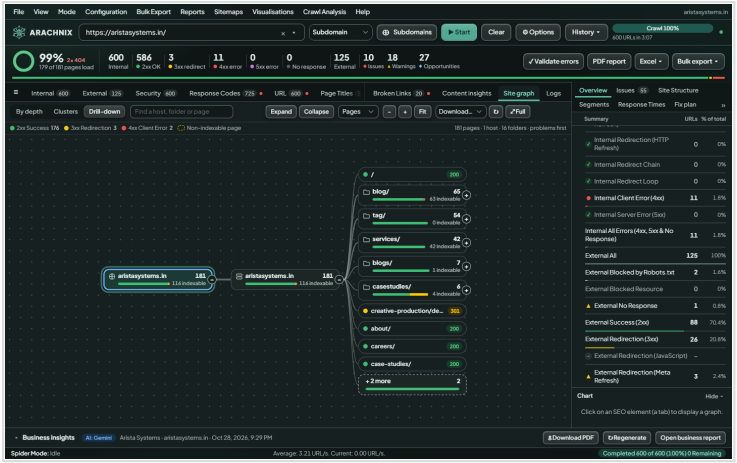
1. Open **File > Settings...** (Ctrl+,) and pick **User Interface**.
2. **Theme**: **Light**, **Dark** or **System default** (follows your computer).
3. **Glass effects**: **On** (frosted glass and a soft light under the pointer), **Reduced** (glass on menus and dialogs only) or **Off** (solid). Press **OK** to keep the change.

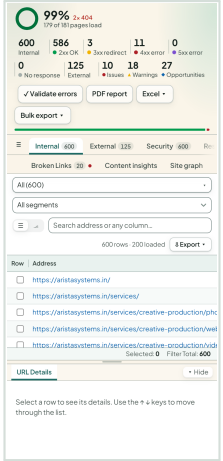


Tip Quicker: **View > Theme** and **View > Glass effects** change it straight from the menu.



The dark theme: results with the Overview (left) and an issue with its fix (right).





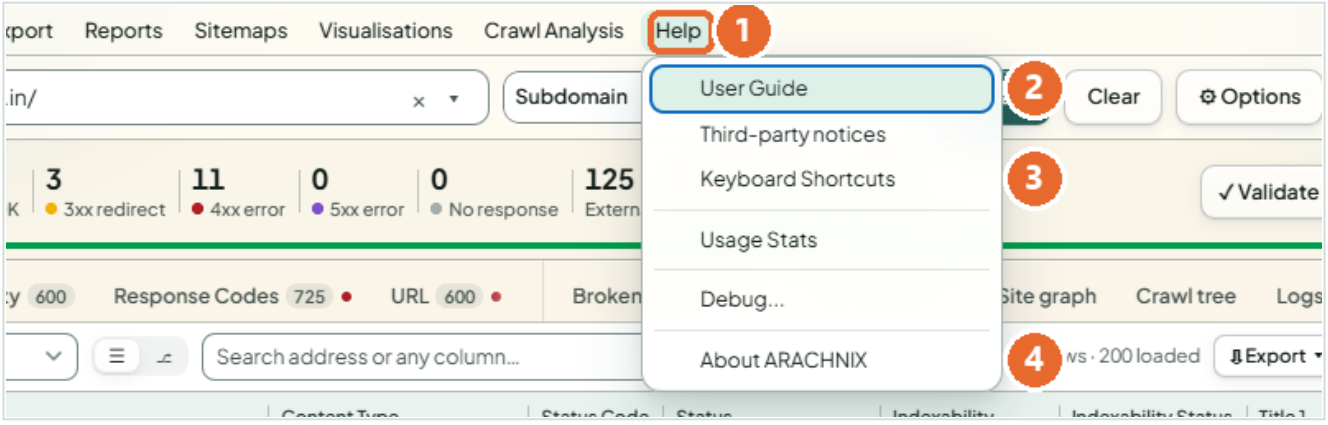
Left: the drill-down site graph in the dark theme. Right: ARACHNIX on a phone: the KPI strip, buttons and grid stack in one column.

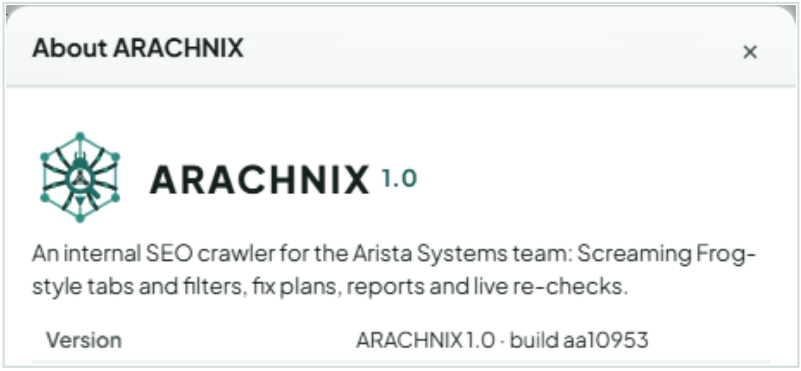
Help

Answers inside the app.

15. The Help menu

1. Open **Help**.
2. **User Guide**: the short guide inside the app.
3. **Keyboard Shortcuts**: every key in one list.
4. **About ARACHNIX**: the version (ARACHNIX 2.0) and the server details to quote when you ask for help.





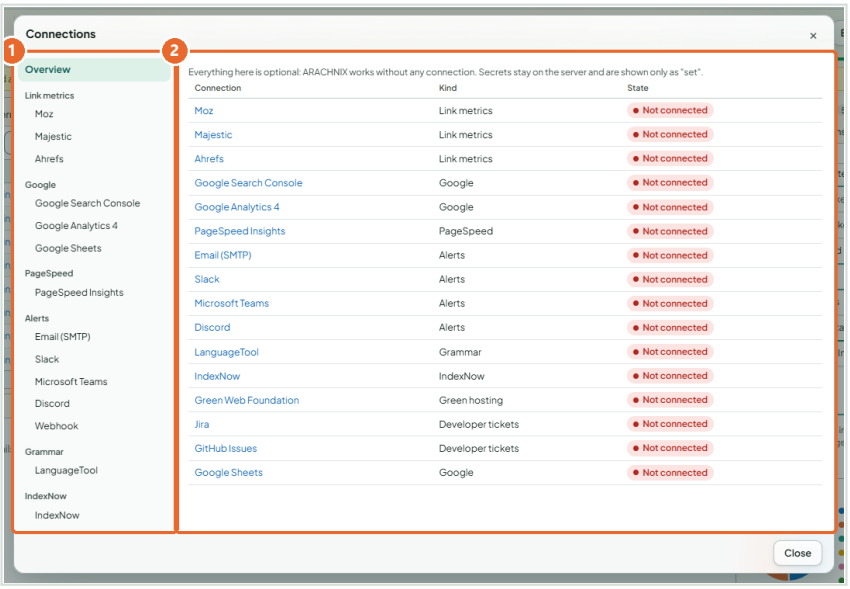
Tip Something looks wrong? **Help > Debug...** shows the server details and the crawl log (no secrets) and can download them as a file to send to the team that runs ARACHNIX.

What's new in 2.0

Connections, AI agents and AI questions, more checks, and new views of the data. Every 2.0 option is off or empty until you set it, so a crawl with the defaults gives the same results as 1.0.

Connect your tools

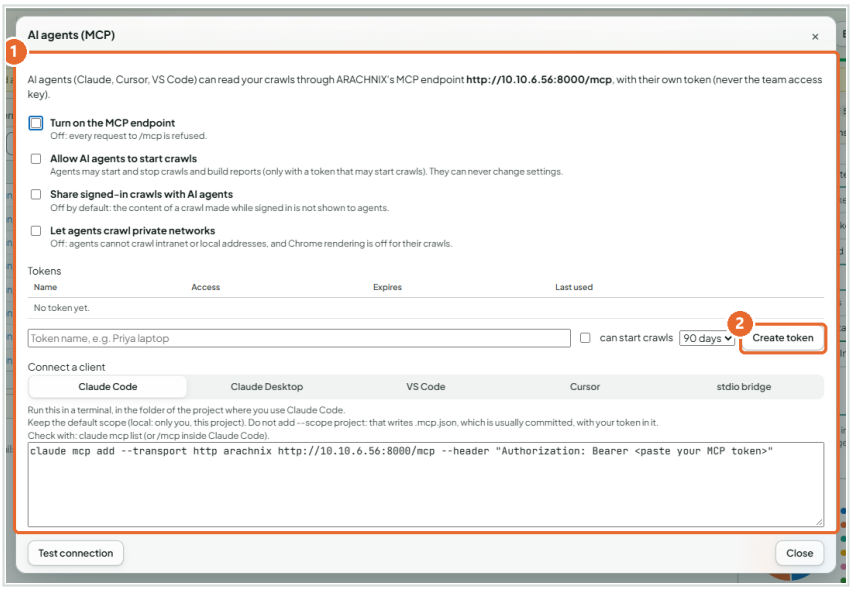
1. **Configuration > Connections** lists every service ARACHNIX can use, grouped by kind: link metrics, Google, PageSpeed, alerts, grammar, IndexNow, developer tickets.
2. Each row says **Connected** or **Not connected**. Click one to connect it (an API key or a Google sign-in) and test it. Keys stay on the server and are only ever shown as "set".



Tip Nothing here is required: a check that needs a missing connection says "Not connected", never 0.

Let AI agents read your crawls (MCP)

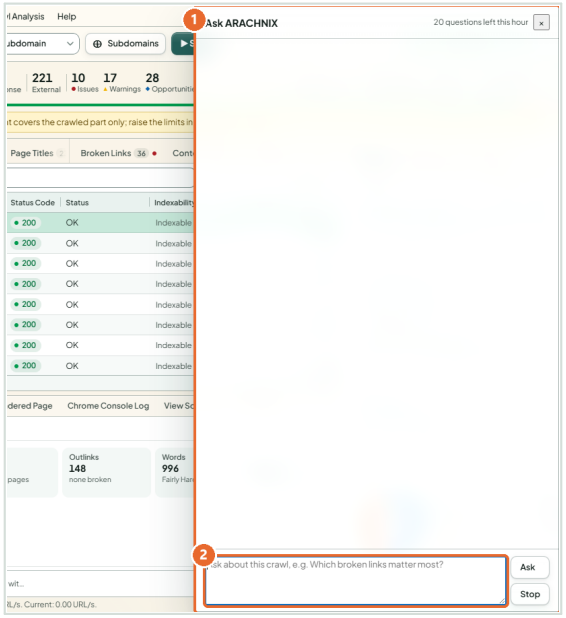
1. **Configuration > AI agents (MCP)**: AI assistants such as Claude, Cursor or VS Code can read your crawls through ARACHNIX's MCP address. Switch the endpoint on, and choose whether agents may start crawls (they can never change settings).
2. **Create a token** for each agent: agents use their own token, never the team access key. Tokens can expire and be removed.



Tip Crawls made while signed in to a site are hidden from agents unless an admin allows it, and agents cannot crawl the office network.

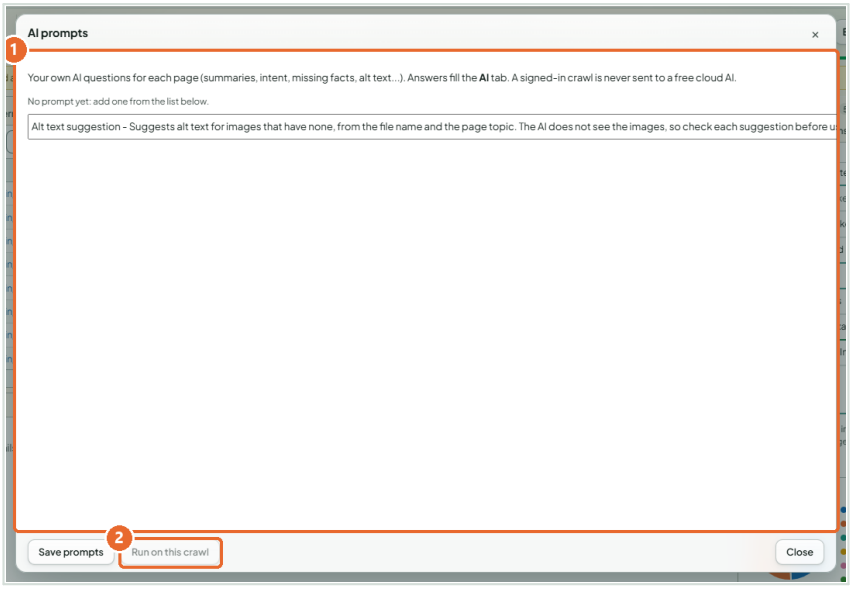
Ask ARACHNIX

1. **Help > Ask ARACHNIX** opens a chat about the crawl on screen: "which pages lost their H1?", "what should I fix first?".
2. Type the question and press Ask. Anything that would change something (start a crawl, build a report) waits for your Allow. The counter shows the questions left this hour.



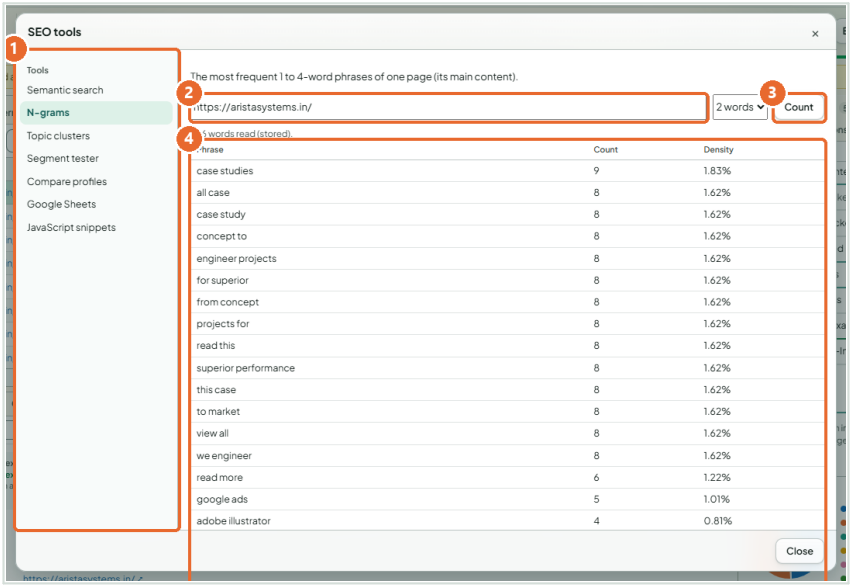
Your own AI questions for every page

1. **Configuration > AI prompts**: pick a ready question (alt text ideas, page intent, language, sentiment, summary...) or write your own.
2. **Run** asks it for every page; the answers fill the **AI** tab. A signed-in crawl is never sent to a free cloud AI.



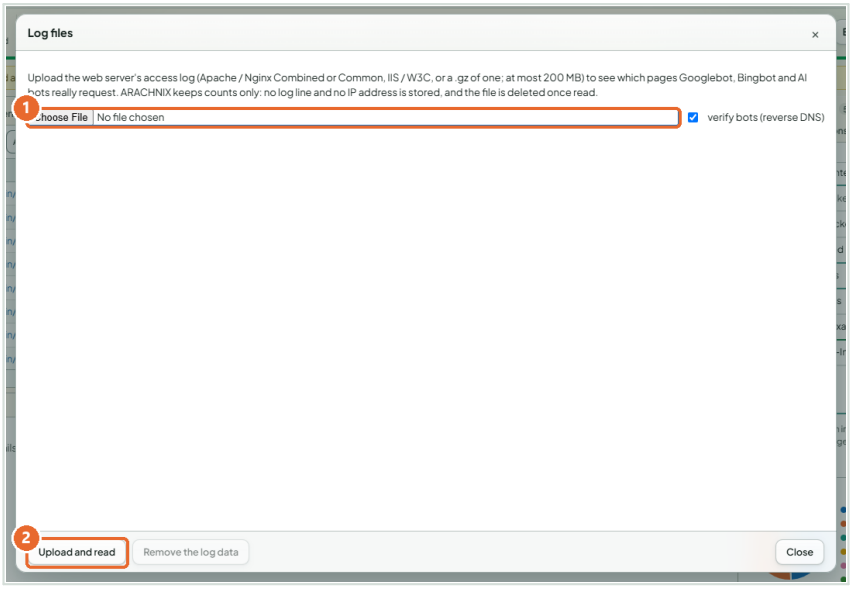
SEO tools

1. **Configuration > SEO tools**: semantic search, n-grams, topic clusters, the segment tester, profile compare, Google Sheets export and the JavaScript snippet library.
2. N-grams: the page selected in the grid is filled in. Choose 1 to 4 words.
3. **Count** lists the most frequent phrases of the page's main content,
4. with their count and share of the words.



Server log files

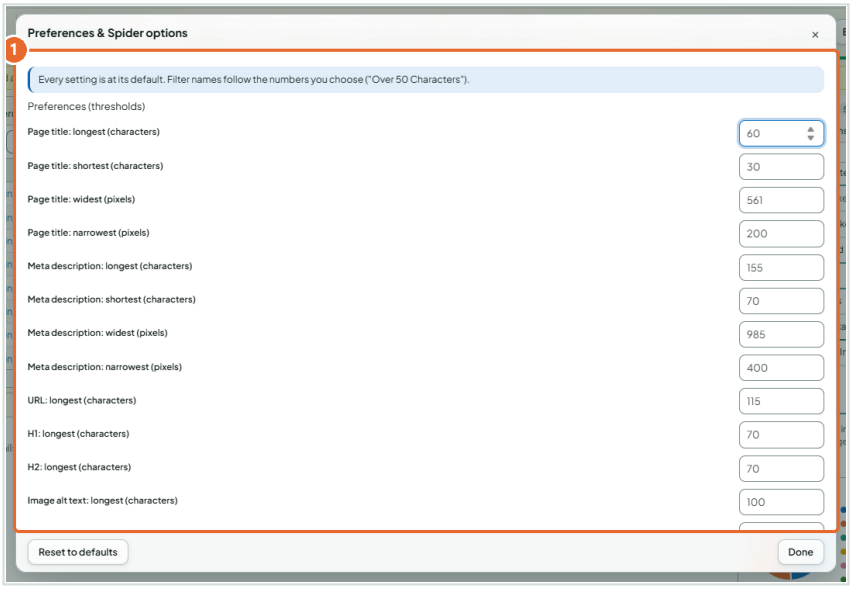
1. Choose the web server's access log (Apache, Nginx, IIS, or a .gz of one, up to 200 MB).
2. **Upload and read**: the Log Files tab shows which pages Googlebot, Bingbot and AI bots really request, fake bots, and URLs bots ask for that the crawl never found.



Tip Only counts are kept: no log line and no IP address is stored, and the file is deleted once read.

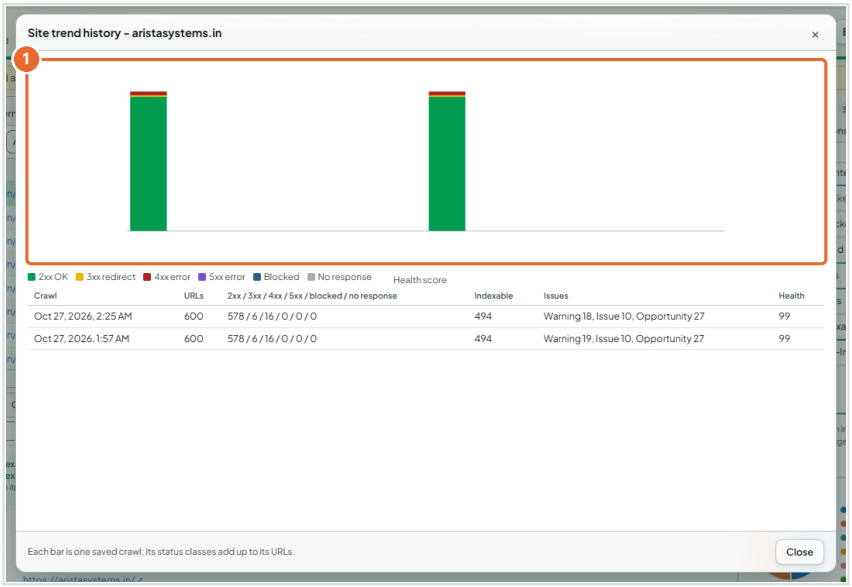
Preferences & Spider options

1. **Configuration > Preferences & Spider options**: the numbers behind the filters (title length, words for "low content", crawl depth...) and the Spider switches (what to follow, limits per folder or host, robots.txt tester). Filter names follow your numbers, for example "Over 50 Characters".



Site trend history

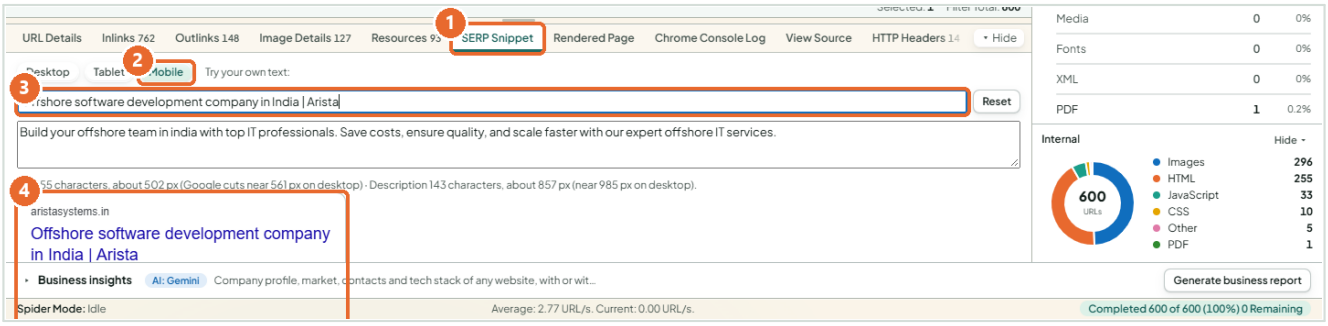
1. **Help > Site trend history**: every saved crawl of the site as one bar. Its status classes add up to its URLs; the table adds indexable pages, issues by type and the health score.



Tip A crawl saved without this data is a gap in the chart, never a 0.

SERP Snippet on phones and tablets

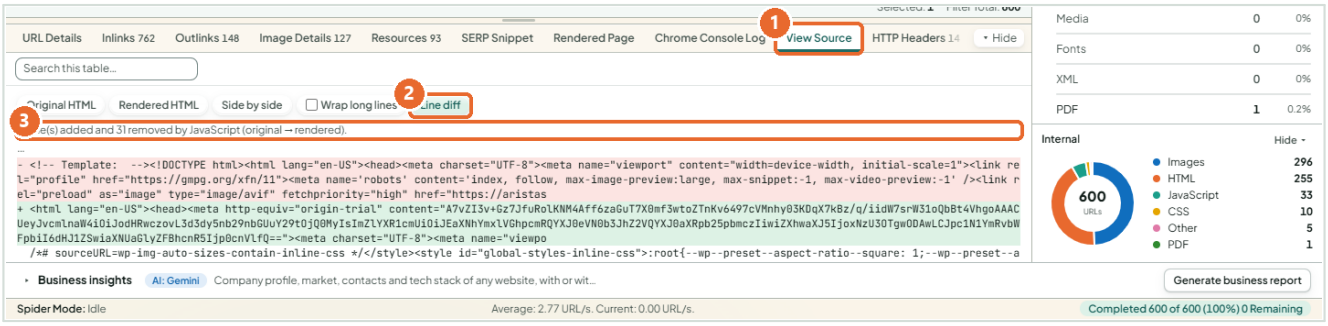
1. Click a row, then the **SERP Snippet** tab at the bottom.
2. **Desktop**, **Tablet** or **Mobile**: how the result could look on each.
3. Type your own title or description: the length in characters and pixels is measured as you type.
4. The preview shows where Google would cut the text. Your text is not saved: copy it into your CMS.



Tip Tablet and mobile are estimates: Google changes its layout and limits often.

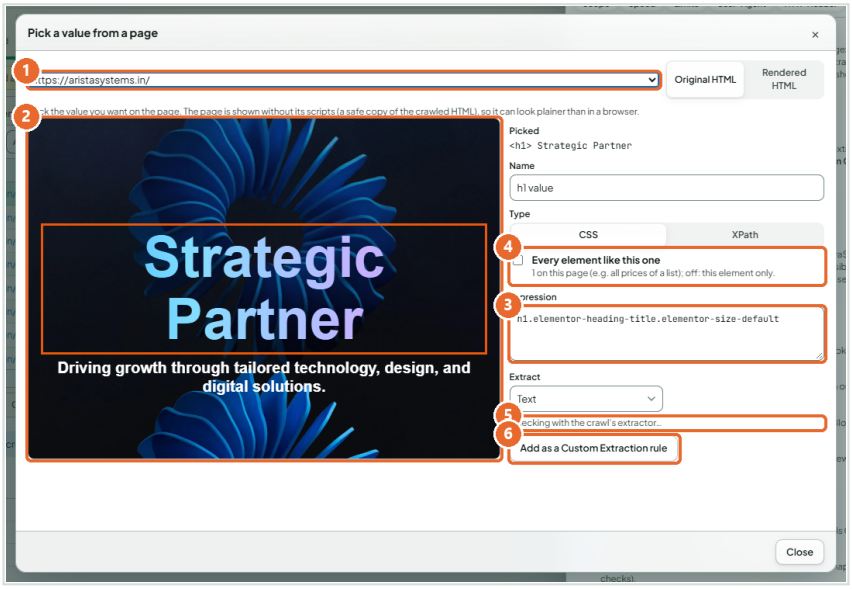
View Source: what JavaScript changed

1. For a page rendered in Chrome, open **View Source**.
2. **Line diff** compares the HTML as downloaded with the HTML after JavaScript ran:
3. how many lines were added (green) and removed (red), with the changed lines only.



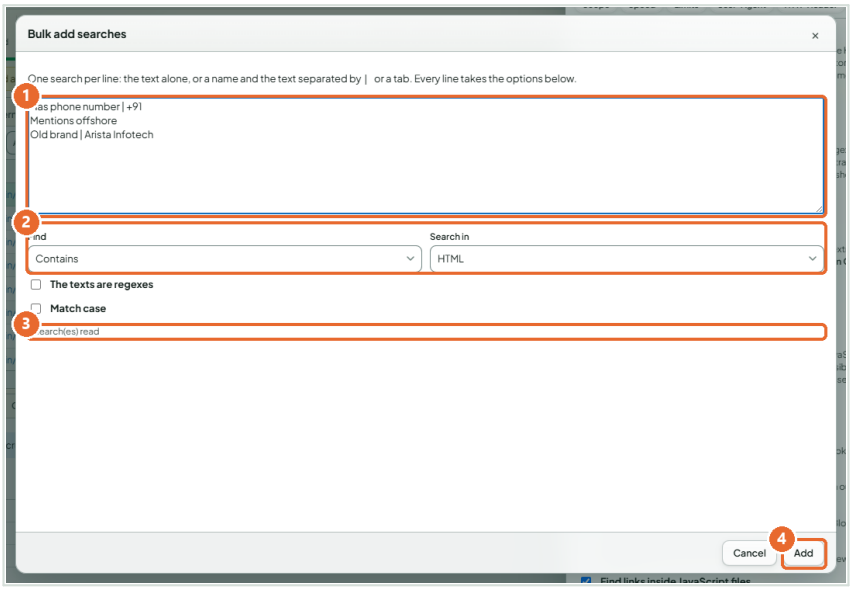
Pick a value from a page (Custom Extraction)

1. **Configuration > Custom Extraction > Pick from a page...**: choose a crawled page, as downloaded or as rendered.
2. The page is shown without its scripts (a safe copy of the crawled HTML). Click the value you want, for example a price or an author.
3. ARACHNIX writes its CSS selector (or XPath) for you; you can edit it.
4. **Every element like this one**: all the prices of a list instead of one.
5. The preview is made by the crawl's own extractor: it is exactly what the crawl will collect.
6. **Add as a Custom Extraction rule**: it runs on every page of the next crawl.



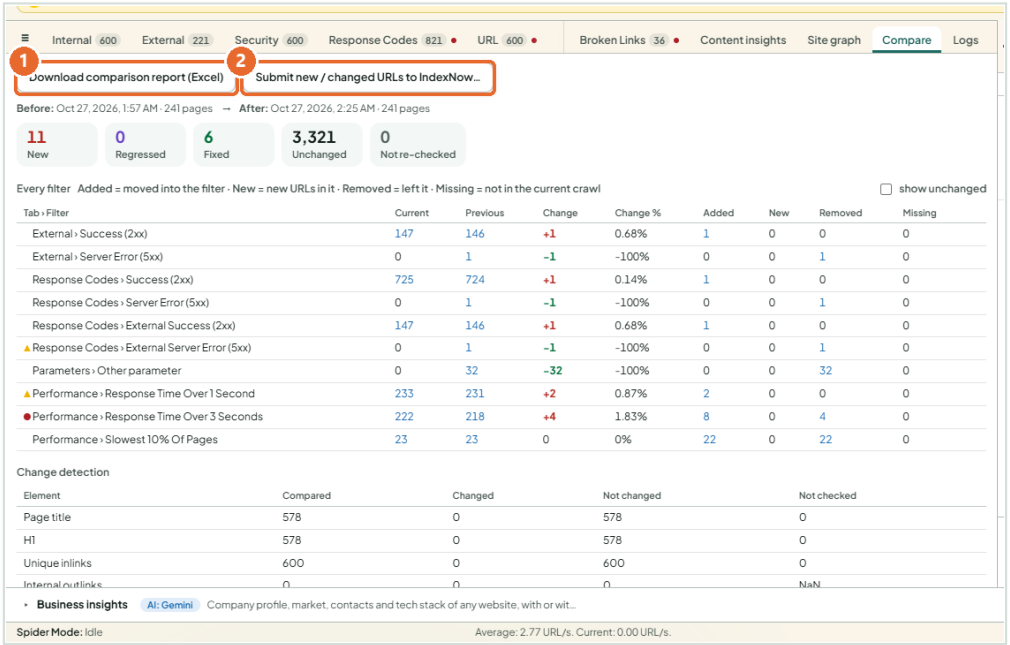
Bulk add searches (Custom Search)

1. **Configuration > Custom Search > Bulk add...**: one search per line, the text alone or a name and the text separated by " | ".
2. Every line takes the same options: contains or does not contain, where to look (HTML, page text, head, body, one element), regex, match case.
3. The count says how many searches were read (at most 10 in all).
4. **Add** puts them in the Custom Search list.



Compare: the report and IndexNow

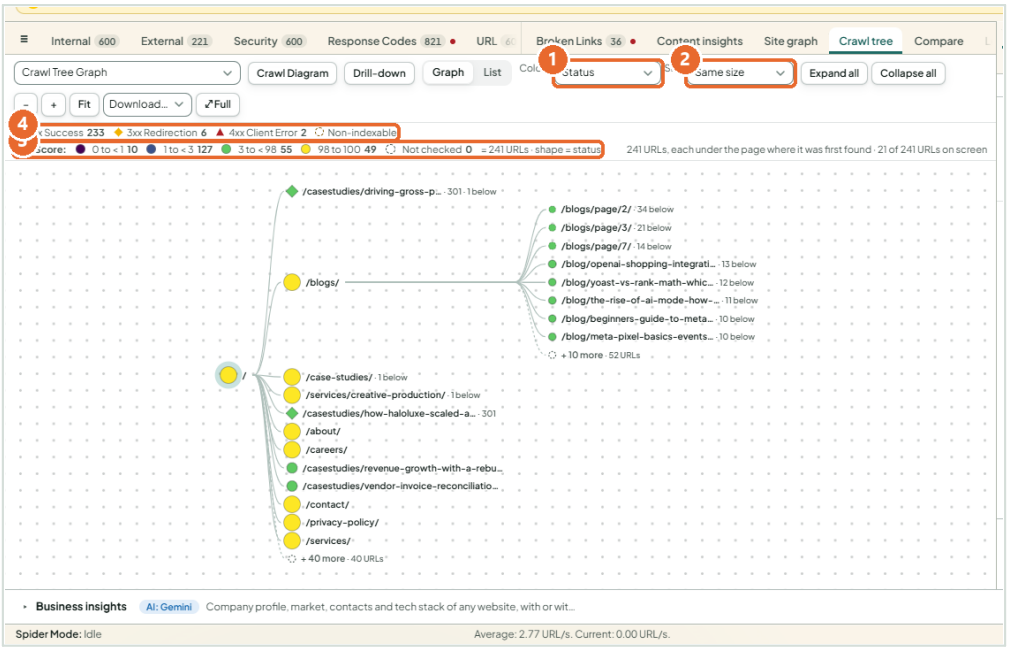
1. After **Mode > Compare**, **Download comparison report (Excel)** saves every filter's before and after.
2. **Submit new / changed URLs to IndexNow...** first says how many URLs would be sent and to which search engines (Bing, Yandex and others; Google does not take part), then asks.



Tip A filter the older crawl did not have yet says "Not checked" for that crawl, never 0. Five more change checks were added: unique inlinks and the internal and external outlink counts.

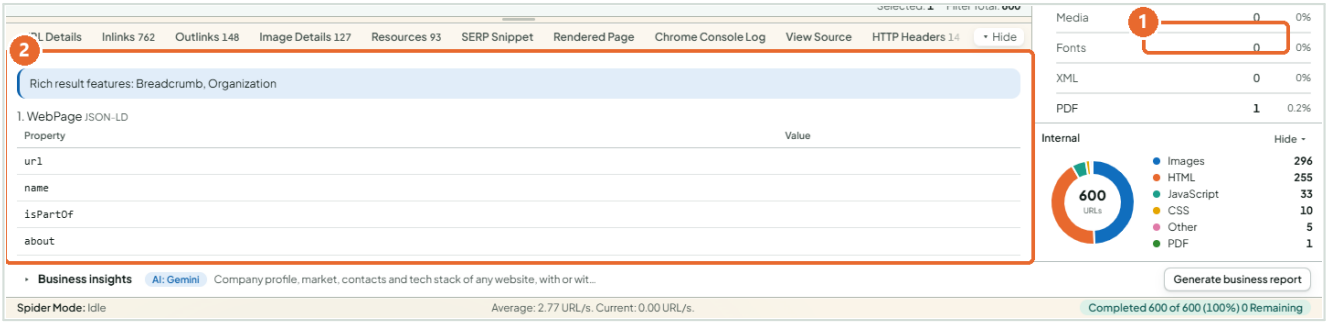
Colour and size the tree graphs

1. **Visualisations > Crawl Tree Graph** (or Directory Tree Graph): **Colour** by crawl depth, indexability, Link Score, unique inlinks, response time or word count.
2. **Size** by one of them too: the bigger the dot, the higher the value.
3. The colour legend: its counts add up to the URLs of the tree. A missing value is "Not checked" (a dashed circle).
4. The shape still shows the status, and the status counts stay the same whatever you pick.



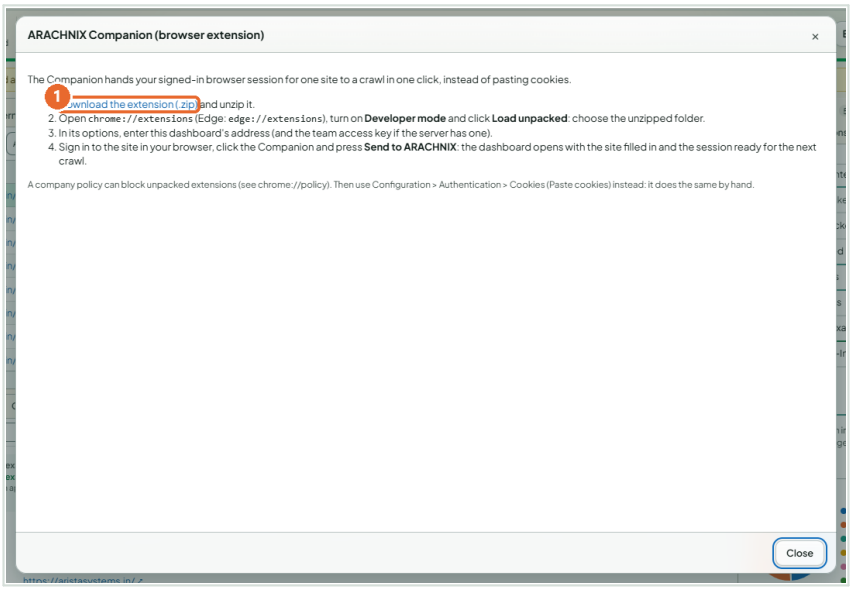
Structured Data Details

1. Click a row, then **Structured Data Details**: every JSON-LD item of the page with its properties, the rich results it can earn, and what the schema.org check found (unknown types or properties, a date that is not a date, a price that is not a number).



The browser extension (sites that need a login)

1. **Help > Browser extension**: download the ARACHNIX Companion for Chrome or Edge and follow the steps. Signed in to a site, one click sends that session to the next crawl (for that site only, used once, within 10 minutes): no cookie pasting.



Quick reference

Where things are	
Start a crawl	Address box, then **Start** (top bar)
Crawl settings	**Options** or **Configuration > Crawl Config** (Ctrl+;)
Crawl a list of URLs	**Mode > List**, then **Upload**
Sign in to a private site	Options > **Authentication (login)**
All tabs	≡ at the left of the tab bar
Issues, Fix plan	Right panel: **Issues**, **Fix plan**
One URL in detail	Click a row; bottom pane tabs
Pages that didn't load	Red link next to the health score (for example **2× 404**)
Re-check broken URLs	**Validate errors** (top right)
Diagrams	**Site graph** tab, **Visualisations** menu; **Download...** saves PNG / SVG
Compare crawls	**History**, or **Mode > Compare**
Excel / CSV	**Excel**, grid **Export**, **Bulk Export** menu
PDF reports	**PDF report**; **Generate business report** / **Regenerate** (bottom)
Saved crawls	**File > Crawls...** (Ctrl+O)
Scheduled crawls	**File > Scheduling** (Alt+Shift+T)
Theme, glass	**View > Theme**, **View > Glass effects**
Connections, AI agents	**Configuration > Connections**, **AI agents (MCP)**
Ask about the crawl	**Help > Ask ARACHNIX**
AI questions per page	**Configuration > AI prompts**; answers in the **AI** tab
N-grams, clusters, testers	**Configuration > SEO tools**
Server logs	**Configuration > Log files**
Pick a value to extract	**Configuration > Custom Extraction > Pick from a page...**
Trend of a site	**Help > Site trend history**

Common filters (tab > filter)	
Broken links	Response Codes > **Internal Client Error (4xx)**
Server errors	Response Codes > **Internal Server Error (5xx)**
Redirects	Response Codes > **Internal Redirection (3xx)**
Long titles	Page Titles > **Over 60 Characters**
Missing descriptions	Meta Description > **Missing**
Missing H1	H1 > **Missing**
Images without alt text	Images > **Missing Alt Text**
Duplicate pages	Content > **Exact Duplicates**, **Near Duplicates**
Pages not in the sitemap	Sitemaps > **URLs not in Sitemap**
Blocked from Google	Directives > **Noindex**; Response Codes > **Blocked by Robots.txt**

Keyboard keys (Help > Keyboard Shortcuts)	
/	Search the grid
↑ ↓, Page Up / Down	Move through the grid
Space	Tick a row (several rows)
Enter	Details of the selected row
Esc	Close a menu or dialog
Ctrl+O	File > Crawls
Ctrl+,	File > Settings
Ctrl+;	Crawl Config

Alt+Shift+N / W / T	New / Close / Scheduling

FAQ

My site needs a login.

Options > **Authentication (login)** > **Log in before crawling**. Use **Email + password** for a normal login form, **Browser window** for two-factor or single sign-on, or **Paste cookies** when the sign-in has a bot check. ARACHNIX never clicks sign-out or links that change data.

The site shows a bot check or blocks the crawler.

ARACHNIX does not try to solve CAPTCHAs. When it sees a bot wall it shows what to do: sign in with **Paste cookies** or **Browser window**, slow the crawl down (Options > **Speed**), or ask the site owner to allow the crawler. The **AI Crawlers** tab shows what Googlebot and AI crawlers get.

The crawl stopped early.

Read the yellow note under the KPI strip. Usually the **Max URLs** or **Max depth** limit was reached (raise it in Options > **Limits**), or someone pressed **Stop**. Every count then covers only the crawled part.

The numbers in the PDF differ from the grid.

They come from the same crawl, so they match when you compare like with like: the PDF counts internal URLs by HTTP status, as the KPI strip does. The grid shows only the current tab, filters and search; clear them (**All**) to see every URL. Issues your team dismissed are left out of both the PDF and the issue counts.

Why do some checks say "not checked"?

They need something this crawl did not have, for example **Render every page in Chrome** (accessibility, JavaScript) or a Google connection (Search Console, GA4, PageSpeed) under **Configuration > API Access**. ARACHNIX never shows a misleading zero.

The browser says the download is insecure or blocked.

ARACHNIX runs on the office network over plain HTTP, so Chrome and Edge may flag a downloaded PDF or Excel file. Choose **Keep** in the browser's download list. A file that took a while to prepare waits behind a **Save** button in the message at the bottom: press **Save**, then **Keep**.

Is a 404 really broken?

Press **Validate errors**: each broken URL is re-checked live three times and marked confirmed, intermittent or already fixed.

Can I run crawls automatically?

Yes: **File > Scheduling** runs a crawl daily, weekly or monthly and can email when it finishes.

Does ARACHNIX work on a phone?

Yes, the dashboard fits a phone screen. For long audits a computer is easier.

More help Need more detail on a check? Click it in the **Issues** panel (What it means, How to fix), or open **Why & Fix** for a URL.